

Shattered Pixel Dungeon the Complete Newb Adventurer's Guide

Chapter I: The Basics

 v3.0.0

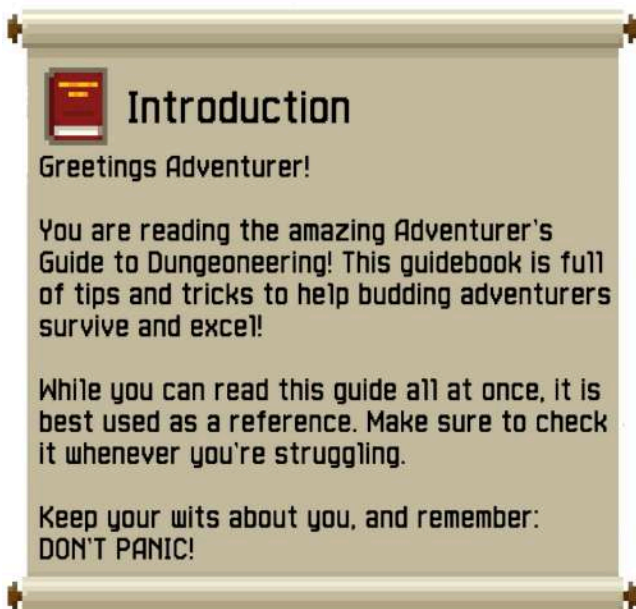


- [Original Reddit Post](#) -

Hello there fellow pixel dungeoneers! Do you die a lot when playing with many active challenges? Do you or a loved one suffer from chronic newbieness? If you answered yes to either of those questions then it's time for you to git gud! And you've come to the right place. These guides have been created as a more permanent way for me to display all the various tips and tricks I have for players. I've beat this game more times than I'm proud of and with experience comes knowledge and a lot of it at that. People often ask for "general advice" which honestly I find to be the toughest type to give in any meaningful way. At least to people who already know the basics and commonly repeated tips. So I've instead opted to thoroughly cover individual aspects of the game. What started as a single small guide has now evolved into a larger series! Though I certainly took my time doing it I've managed to finish 7 chapters! I've also

made an all-challenge walkthrough video of sorts showing me utilizing all the tips and tricks given throughout this guide [here](#). Let me know if there are any mistakes throughout the chapters. With a guide this big there's bound to be at least one, or more likely, several. You can also let me know if you think there's any useful information that I might've missed.

Those basics and commonly repeated tips is where I'll be starting though. If you've been around a while you can probably skip this chapter. But otherwise it should be worth a read. There's already a nice in-game guide available that you should have read. I'm going to be adding more information alongside it.





Gaining Experience

As you defeat enemies your level of experience will increase. Your experience determines how accurate your attacks are, how easily you can dodge, and how much health you have.

Your experience level makes a big difference in combat. It's best to have at least one level for each floor of the dungeon.

It can be tempting to rush through a dungeon, avoiding exploration and combat, but doing so will deprive you of both supplies and experience.

(You can see information about your hero, including exp, on the status pane at the top of the game interface. Tap on your hero portrait to get even more info)

First rule of the dungeon is not to rush. I'm not just talking about taking time to think about your actions. You want to be fully, or at least mostly exploring each depth before moving on to stay ahead of hunger. You also want to try and keep yourself at roughly the same level as the depth you're on or higher. This should happen fairly naturally though.

Next we have an essential survival technique: Sneak attacks! They allow you to bypass the accuracy check. You can kite enemies through doors as mentioned, bend around walls/tall grass, use the Rogue's cloak of shadows, etc... Anytime you can break sight. Which is pretty often. You're ideally going to be doing these quite a bit on all enemies. But there's a few in particular that have an unholy evasion stat. Making it essential. Enemies such as snakes and wraiths can evade attacks all day but die to a single blow once you know how to land one.



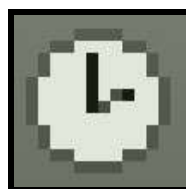
Surprise Attacks

One of the best ways to get the upper hand in combat is with surprise attacks.

A surprise attack occurs whenever you attack an enemy while you are out of their sight, or right as you come into view. Even the most evasive of enemies can't dodge a surprise attack!

One of the most common parts of the environment you can use to surprise enemies is a door. An enemy will be open to a surprise attack right as they move through a closed door.

(When you successfully land a surprise attack, a yellow exclamation mark will briefly appear on top of the enemy you just struck)

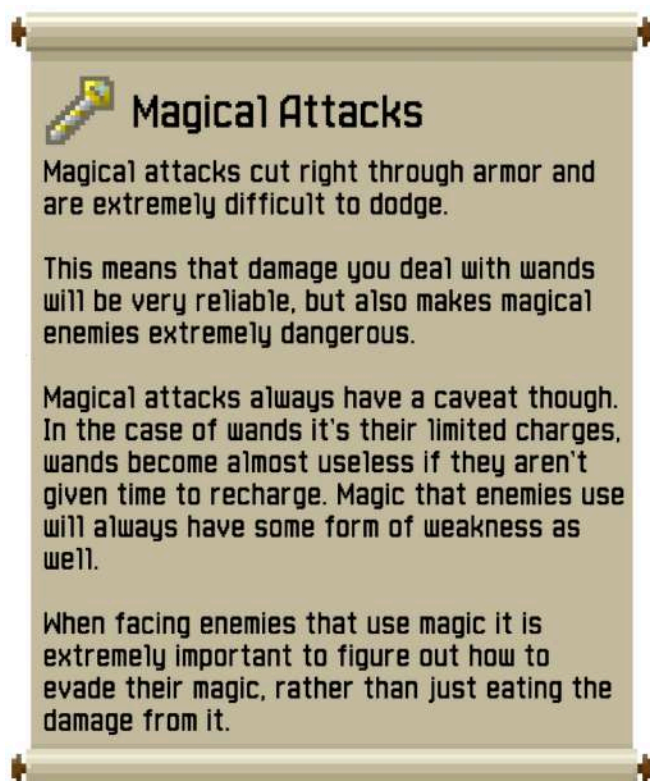


Let's take a minute to appreciate the wait button here. It is your friend. You'll find that ideal play uses it a lot. First use is when an enemy is only 1 tile away. You should never be handing the first attack to an enemy. Instead use this button to pass your turn. Against fast enemies such as crabs or bats you should only wait if there's 2 tiles of space and instead back up a tile when there's only 1.

Next thing you should be doing is funneling enemies. There's no reason to be trading hits with more than 1 enemy at once. Use doors, corridors or whatever's available to only fight one out of a time. Especially important for enemies that naturally come in groups. Such as flies or ghouls.



The wait button is also a rest button. Use it to wait out negative effects. Hold it down to put your hero to sleep and cause time to pass rapidly. This can be used to quickly replenish your health and wand/artifact charge, but also respawn enemies and deplete your hunger in the process. Best not done on the same floor you're struggling with. The stairs both up and down can be used as a quick getaway. If it's ever necessary an alternate depth should serve as a great place to rest.



The secret to defeating ranged enemies is to not eat their ranged attacks. Well, I suppose that's not really a secret. The easiest way to do this is to lure them into melee range. Provided you're not grossly underequip they won't pose much of a threat up close. Find something to hide behind when you see them coming. Such as a door, wall or statue.

If they're still asleep then don't charge in or attack them. A sleeping enemy can act instantly should you damage them. They however must wait a turn before they can act if they're woken up by you simply being within their line of sight. Wait for them to awaken then retreat behind cover.

If there's an enemy you'd just rather not be fighting at this time or place, then don't. Wait a few turns for them to move somewhere else. There's no reason for you to be fighting enemies on their terms.

Wands are easily the strongest items in the game when used properly. They're a source of ranged damage that bypasses both enemy armor and evasion. They also each have their own unique effects giving them incredible utility value and the highest skill ceiling of any item type in the game. One neat thing most can do is reliably deal the final blow to an enemy. When an enemy is weak enough it no longer matters how powerful an attack is, but just whether or not it lands. Though sneak attacks are preferable where possible to preserve charges.



Not all actions take an even 1 turn. Some take a little more, some a little less. Whenever that number isn't an integer it's tracked by the partial turn indicator (PTI) just under the hero portrait until it's either used or reset by ascending/descending. Make sure to pay attention to it whenever working with equipment that doesn't take even turns. Such as a spear or studded gloves.





Effective Looting

Specific rooms will often contain better loot than others. Some of these rooms will be behind locked doors, or will contain obstacles which must be navigated past.

Whenever an obstacle like this blocks your progress, look for a solution nearby. Whether it's a key or something more crafty, there is usually a tool you can use on the same floor.

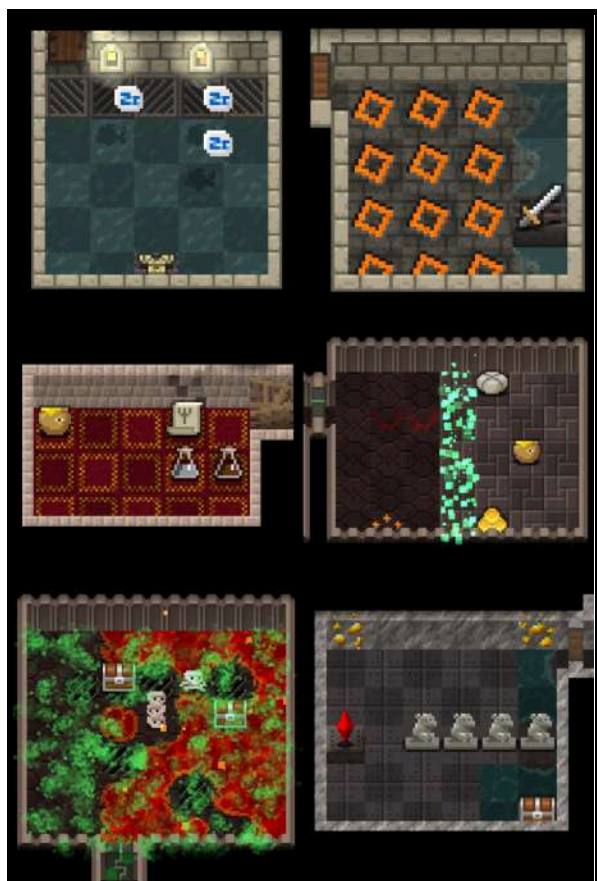
Potions of strength and scrolls of upgrade are an excellent measure of how well you're exploring and looting. You will be able to find 3 scrolls of upgrade and 2 potions of strength per dungeon region.

(You can see a list of important landmarks and unused keys in the notes tab of the journal window.)

As it says there are 3 scrolls of upgrade (SoU) and 2 potions of strength (PoS) per chapter for a total of 15 scrolls and 10 potions. One on either the 1st/2nd floor of a chapter and the other on the 3rd/4th in the case of strength. Ideally you want to drink the very first PoS as soon as possible as it makes a noticeable impact in combat.

What it means by "tool" is potion. Certain potions can act as a sort of "key" to puzzle rooms. For example, whenever there's a room with 3 piranhas blocking the path to a chest there will always be a potion of **invisibility** located somewhere on that same depth to allow you safe passage. **Levitation** if the room is filled with traps/chasm, **liquid flame** if it's blocked by a wooden barricade, **frost** if there's a green wall of eternal fire, **purity** if the room is perpetually filled with toxic gas or **haste** if there's a red sentry guarding a chest. It may be wise to hold off on drinking any un-ID'd potions found on the current depth until you've confirmed it's free of these rooms. At least until these key potions are identified. There's a free stone of intuition somewhere between depths 1-3 to make picking the right early game potion easier. Only one non-secret potion puzzle room will appear on a single depth. So once you see one you at least don't have to worry about there being a second.

The last puzzle room is one that's locked from the inside. This one however doesn't require a potion. Instead you must jump down from the previous depth. Look for a dead end room with a chasm and distant well visible towards the back. Such as seen in the top image to the right. That's where you need to jump.



You're trading resources when doing this so do consider whether or not it's actually worth it. You don't always have to take the trade, especially if you know there's not any important items like SoU or PoS inside. The distant well rooms in particular are situational. I often ignore these outside of the Sewers where natural regeneration is still very potent.

Many items that aren't specifically given to you for these areas can still help with them. The distant well rooms for example can be entered without taking damage by crafting the feather fall elixir. You could also use something to cure the bleed such as a seed of mageroyal. There's actually a lot of alternative solutions to these. The Ethereal Chains/Timekeeper's Hourglass proving particularly versatile. I'm not gonna list every possible way to clear these rooms. Just some of the more common ones:



Liquid Flame: Barricades can be destroyed with wands of fireblast or disintegration. As well as with seeds of firebloom or even bombs/stones of blast.

Frost: Fire can be extinguished with a wand of frost or with potions of purity/stormclouds/aqua brew. A seed of icecap can also work provided you're able to plant it over water or trigger its effect instantaneously.

Levitation: Aqua brew can disable any traps and stones of flock can absorb most. If you wanna get a little creative, you could also use a stone of blast with telekinetic grab or the Ally Warp talent.

Purity: Aqua brew can eliminate the inactive traps that generate the toxic gas. The ring of elements or the Shield Battery talent can help protect you from the damage. If it's early enough in the game you can even just tank the damage outright and rest it off. (P.S. Don't drink unidentified potions whilst standing in the toxic gas. Paralytic gas could be a death sentence in there!)

Haste: Aqua brew can flood the special tiles that allow it to target you. A ring of haste is also a direct substitute for the potion.

Invisibility: The Rogue's cloak is a direct substitute for the potion. The Huntress' bow, a weapon with extended reach or a sufficiently strong wand can safely pick them off. Fishing spears may help as well, dealing substantial damage to piranhas. Phase shift, a wand of blast wave or the ethereal chains can drag them onto land, killing them instantly. Killing them also comes with the bonus of free meat. Yum!

Don't eat raw mystery meat though! Uncooked meat gives off various negative effects. There's 3 different ways to cook it. Burning, freezing or stewing in an alchemy pot. Freezing is most beneficial as frozen meat actually gives various positive effects while the rest are only neutral. You also don't even need to use your items to do so. Just wait until you come across a trap that produces frost/fire. Wands of fireblast/frost can serve your run exceptionally well in this regard. Frost simply requires the bolt to collide with something for it to work. So make sure you place your food against a wall.

At the start of each chapter there will be a shop to spend your gold. They're fairly predictable in what they stock. There's always a bag, weapon, armor, ankh, stone of augmentation, 2 small food rations, darts, throwing weapons, bomb(s)/honeypot, alchemize, at least 1 potion of healing (PoH), scroll of identify (ID), remove curse (RC), magic mapping (MM) and various other random potions/scrolls. Knowing the guaranteed scrolls can help you deduce what they may be. Rarer consumables have higher prices if ID'd so you can also use this to get a discount if you can buy them while they're still un-ID'd. MM is a particularly easy example of this.



Your first priority should be buying the bag. You can actually choose which one you'd like too. The shop bag is determined by which one will free up the most inventory space. So all you need to do is drop all of your other would-be bagged items (except those belonging to your desired bag) before descending to the shop depth. After the bag you wanna buy any PoH that are available. The rest I will leave up to you. Just please don't buy the terribly overpriced weapon/armor.



Examining and Searching

Charging forward recklessly is a great way to get killed.

There's always time to slow down and examine things around you, which can help you figure out the best way to approach a situation. Rushing into enemies is almost never the best way to deal with them.

Dungeons are full of secret passages and traps which appear invisible at first glance. It's good to be willing to thoroughly search an area if you suspect something is hidden.

(The magnifying glass button is used for examining and searching. Tap it once and then tap on something to examine, tap it twice to search the area around you)

Now let's take a minute to focus on this button here. The examine button can be used to instantly pull up information about anything anytime. Use it whenever you see something that you're unfamiliar with. A few things you might find yourself frequently examining are:



- Animated statues: Tells you what weapon they're wielding so that you can gauge their lethality and if it's worth looting.
- Crystal chests: Tells you what item type is inside, so that you may choose your preferred one.
- Debuffed enemies: Tells you the duration/severity of any effects they have when tapping on the debuff icons.

Double tapping it turns it into the search button. Useful for uncovering hidden traps and doors throughout the dungeon. Hidden doors may simply open up new routes to better traverse the floor or, if you're lucky, reveal a completely secret room with bonus loot! Unlike Vanilla you'll almost never have to go around randomly searching every wall trying to find a regular room that's completely hidden. In Shattered, with the exception of depths where **"The atmosphere hints that this floor hides many secrets"**, every non-secret room has at least one non-secret route to it. These secrets are more of a bonus if you do find them sort of thing anyway. Not something to worry about getting all of. The most obvious place to search for hidden doors are dead ends in corridors. While unfortunately secret rooms will never be attached to corridors, (I guess that would be a little too easy.) There are still many room types that may give away the location of hidden doors. The easiest example being these platform rooms.



Often upon finding the initial hidden door to a secret the only thing you'll see is a small maze-like room. Searching around it will open the way to a secret area! These little fillers are not to be confused with an actual secret room that consists of a large maze and a chest hidden somewhere inside. You'll look like a dumbass searching the walls of the latter.

Whenever searching you should be maximizing efficiency by taking 3 (5 if playing as the Rogue) steps away from where you last searched so as to not overlap your attempts. A couple other things: There's no point in searching on depth 1, as it



never has any hidden doors/traps. Or after drinking from a well of knowledge as it reveals them all as well as the locations of all items on the floor. Searching depletes hunger faster than any other action so best to reduce redundancy.

The other thing to search for is traps. While searching every tile to avoid them is far from realistic, there are certain tile types that are notably safer than others. Grass, water, embers, special and decorated tiles are always good to step on. Basically anything that isn't a standard tile. Stick to those when you can!

Ranged traps are never hidden. These include worn/poison dart, rockfall, disintegration and grim. What's the point of a trap that's never hidden? Well they accomplish 2 things. A: They kill stupid people. And B: They can be turned against enemies to great effect. They launch a deadly projectile which seeks out the nearest target. Grim traps going as far as to instantly kill said target! So send them towards enemies, not yourself. Rockfall traps work a bit differently though. They drop rocks on every tile of the room they're in, including the doors. Many other traps can be turned on enemies as well of course. These are just some of the most potent and readily available.



Pictured below is the only regular room which actually warns of hidden traps. Beware when you see embers and/or (inactive) traps from the start! These rooms are filled with either hidden burning or explosive traps. Here you should always search (or press) every plain tile that's in your path. And be careful not to auto-path across. It might not take the same route you previously took through the room. One more handy tip is that traps never spawn under items here. At least, not by fault of the ember room.



Next I'm going to cover item identification. Unidentified items get a purple background, known cursed red and known clean blue. Apart from making your items unremovable, curses give your weapons/armor various negative effects, reduce the effective level of a ring, cause wands to cast chaotic spells or artifacts to give off their own unique negative effects. Under normal circumstances all items which can be cursed have a flat 30% chance of hiding one. Whenever equipping an unidentified item for any reason you have to consider this possibility. This is especially true if said item requires more strength than you currently possess. Though I honestly can't say much because in most cases I'm the kind of person to just equip whatever I want and worry about curses later.



Identifying Items

Identifying items can be just as important as finding them!

The colors on potions and glyphs on scrolls are different in each dungeon, so you won't know what effect you'll get if they're unidentified.

Unidentified equipment can be upgraded if you're lucky, or it might be cursed! Accidentally equipping a cursed item is bad, but usually isn't instant doom.

Scrolls of identify, upgrade, or remove curse are very useful if you want to reduce the risk of unidentified items.

(You can find a list of all the items you've identified in the items tab of your journal)

There are many ways to combat these curses. 3 of which are the aforementioned scrolls of upgrade, identify and remove curse. ID scrolls (and stones of detect magic) can safely expose curses without actually equipping an item. RC scrolls can, as the name implies, remove any single curse from any single item without fail. SoU can cleanse curses as well, but only have a $\frac{1}{3}$ success rate. They can however weaken curses on certain item types without fail. For weapons/armor this means being able to unequip them and for rings having the negative effect reduced through being a higher level. Unfortunately though they're incompatible with artifacts and you know, your source of upgrades.



Wells are a great resource as well. Stepping in a well of knowledge will fully ID every item you have equipped as well as curse detect your entire inventory. Best to equip any un-ID'd items that you know are clean to maximize benefit. Stepping in a well of health will fully cleanse every item you have equipped as well as fully heal and satiate you. Best to equip as many items as possible to find cursed ones to cleanse. You can also ID/RC any individual item respectively by throwing it inside or fill your waterskin in a well of health. You do however miss out on the many other benefits of drinking from a well when throwing an item in.



Other side is consumable identification. You'll start with a few pre-ID'd. That is the scroll of identify along with a potion and an additional scroll that varies depending on your played class. Just don't forget that you won't be finding these un-ID'd if playing as their class. I know I've had times when I was playing as the Mage and making sure there was water nearby before drinking an un-ID'd potion and then thinking to myself "Wait a minute,".



There are many ways to “soft” ID consumables. Meaning you know what they are but haven't yet formally removed their purple background. I've actually mentioned a couple already. The consumables that are guaranteed to appear in shops or as keys to puzzle rooms are examples of items you might soft-ID. Another one is knowing which enemies drop which items. Flies, necromancers, vampire bats and demon spawners all exclusively drop PoH. Elementals drop specific potions/scrolls depending on their type, succubus/scorpios never drop identify/healing, spectral necromancers drop RC and acidic scorpios experience. If you happen to learn anything about an un-ID'd item's identity then don't forget to add a note to it through the journal.



You can always ID items the old fashioned way too of course. By either using them at random or converting them into energy. Scrolls can even be ID'd by merely being split into stones, though it is a one way process. This is good for if you simply want them ID'd for future use or if your bag is full and you need to free up space.

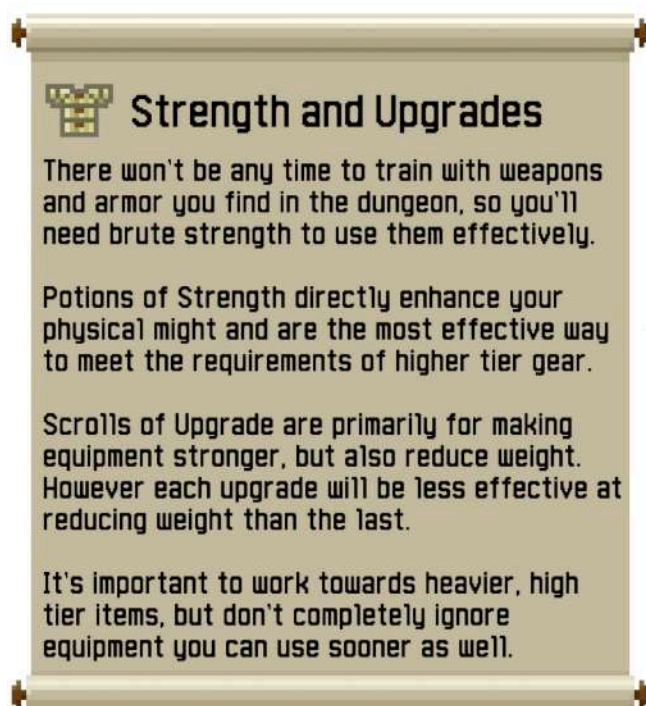
Un-ID'd scrolls are actually surprisingly handy in a pinch! And the ones that aren't are also likely already ID'd. Potions on the other hand are much more of a gamble. If I'm using an un-ID'd potion in a pinch it's usually because I need to clear the caustic ooze/burning debuff. Throwing a potion on yourself counts as a turn spent in water!

When ID'ing potions through use you must drink them to get a guaranteed ID. Half of them won't have any effect if thrown and even thrown potions are only ID'd if you actually see them shatter. These beneficial-only potions include strength, healing, mind vision, invisibility, haste and experience. If a flask ever shatters harmlessly, it was one of these. So unless you have a hunch on what an un-ID'd potion might be I'd recommend drinking it. To protect against the risk of said potion being harmful you should exercise certain precautions depending on which are yet to be ID'd. Try to place yourself:

- In/near water if liquid flame is yet to be ID'd.
- Edge/outside of water if frost is yet to be ID'd.
- On a fresh depth or hidden away in a dead end room if paralytic gas is yet to be ID'd.
- In a room with space to flee diagonally or near a door if toxic gas is yet to be ID'd.

Though relatively minor in comparison, scrolls do possess a few downsides themselves. Retribution briefly blinds and weakens you. Reducing your physical damage, limiting your sight and preventing you from reading more scrolls. Rage acts as an alarm, instantly awakening the entire depth. Teleportation may throw you into an awkward position and any negative effect will also scare off the shopkeeper if he's within sight, including through mind vision.

Wasting the positive effects of a scroll often will hurt just as much if not more than suffering the negative effects. A scroll like MM would lose the majority of its benefit if read later in the depth. Lullaby you want to be able to read without being disturbed to benefit from the healing. Transmutation would be largely wasted without a target item, which would be a shame for such a rare and powerful scroll. Though I personally don't really worry about this stuff much because I generally don't read scrolls randomly unless I'm looking for a specific one or on the backfoot/have a lot of enemies in view.

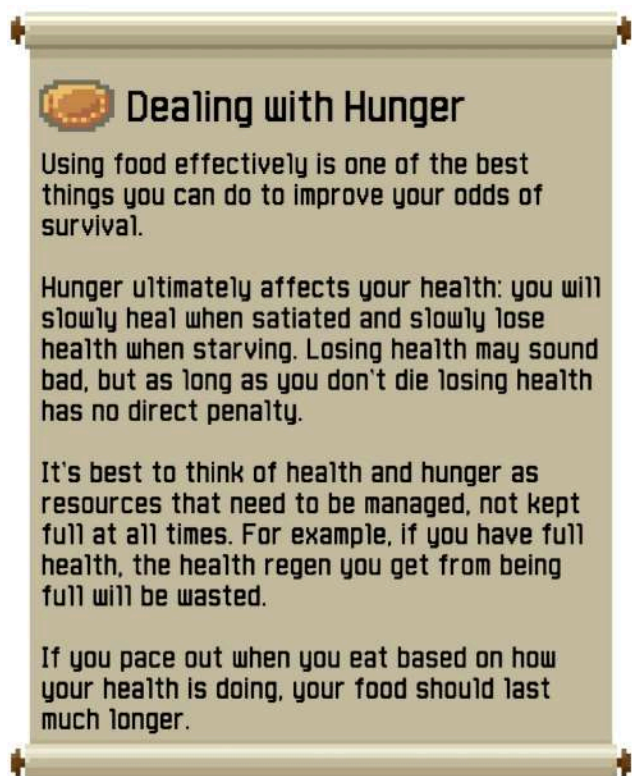


Don't use equipment that's too heavy for you! Weapons lose the ability to sneak attack, have an attack speed penalty and a severe accuracy penalty if the strength requirement isn't met. Armor gets a reduction in movement speed and a severe reduction to DR and evasion. If you're just 1 point shy then in some cases it may be worth using an item that's significantly better than what you currently have, but otherwise follow the rule. This means there's no point in upgrading something you lack the strength to use. Hold onto your scrolls, you may find something better to upgrade anyway. Strength reductions occur at +1, 3, 6, 10, etc... 1 and 3 being the most noteworthy as those are the ones that will most often realistically allow you to equip your gear sooner.

Different classes have different options for spending their early upgrades. The Warrior can preserve 1 upgrade from his seal/armor and the Mage 1 from his staff. This means putting your first upgrade into these is completely free and should basically always be done. The rest of the classes are a bit trickier though. I strongly recommend upgrading something. Be it +1ing a tier-2, +3ing a tier-3 or upgrading a wand/ring. A wand can be a great choice if you find one as it's both a fantastic short and long-term investment. Rings are a little more dependent on which ones you find though. They all stick with you but in a way they're just an extension of your current power. A lot of them might not be that immediately impactful.

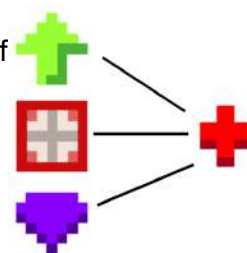
Something many people suggest is to hoard all of your upgrades and dump them into a single late game item. I actually disagree with this! Not to say that it can't be done. It can. And I suppose it's not the worst strategy ever. Just far from the most efficient. Upgrading low tier items may feel like a waste as they're only short-term but they can make a huge impact on your early game success. The early game is just as if not more dangerous than the late game. You should treat it as such. In Shattered it's perfectly reasonable to win every run so there's little reason to let yourself die in half of them. To put a little more emphasis on this, **even in my all-challenge runs I often spend an upgrade or 2 on the short-term.** Hell, my current speedrun record spent an upgrade on a tier-2. Though if you do make a short-term investment be smart about it. If you +1 a tier-2 weapon then don't upgrade a tier-3, wait for at least tier-4. If you upgraded mail then don't bother investing in scale, find some plate. You get what I'm saying? The lowest you wanna settle for as your long-term equipment is tier-3. Tier-3 weapons are perfectly viable for

the late game and mail armor, while borderline, is passable if the rest of your build is strong.



Another thing people might disagree with me on is that I recommend splitting upgrades between several different items. This is because dumping them all into the same one quickly leads to diminishing returns and deprives you of synergy. It also makes it harder to keep your items enchanted. There's a free enchantment stone somewhere between depths 6-19. Once you're happy with your weapon, use it and stop upgrading it. This is a bit less important with armor as there's an arcane stylus in each chapter to keep it glyphed. I try to refrain from crafting my own enchantment stones/scrolls. Exception being the Huntress. It's a good idea to throw an early SoU into alchemy to enchant her bow as soon as possible.

Upgrades, just like hunger, consumables, health and everything else, are a resource. HP being the most important as you can never have too much of it. If you think about it, all others translate to it in some way. As long as you have HP you're alive. To be alive is to not be dead and every step taken while not dead brings you a step closer to victory. My decision making process is basically me trying to figure out what will save me the most HP in the long run. It's very hard to call a strategy ineffective when it's saving you far more HP compared to others.



Don't die trying to save your resources. Remember there's no prize for winning without them. Regardless of whether or not you win or lose, items are worthless if they end in your inventory. Don't get me wrong I'm not saying you should be wasteful of course. If you're comfortable in your situation then that's fine. Naturally you should rely on your equipment first. But if you're hoarding resources like a jackass while chugging HP pots every depth then that's a problem. You're bleeding more resources than you're trying to save. Basically you should be weighing how useful something may be now against how realistically useful it may be later. Finding the balance can be tough but with time you can train your judgment to be pretty good.

Get used to utilizing all of your various consumables. Be it by helping you out of a jam or keeping you from getting into one in the first place. They can make a bigger impact than you might think. One powerful and classic combo is mind vision + AoE scrolls such as lullaby, psionic blast or dread to knock out an entire depth. But it could also be as simple as just throwing a potion of liquid flame at the right time and place. Find out which items are best for which scenarios. You don't want to always rely on what's easiest to use. PoH are the best

example of this. They're a means of recovering HP, not a crutch to strong-arm enemies. They're the most common potion by far, but don't mistake common for expendable. They're also the most valuable.



With that said drink your fucking health potions. If you believe there's even a 1% chance you'll die the next turn it's best to play it safe. This game has no save/load feature so your stingy habits from other games must die. Whether you do it because of greed or just plain stubbornness I can guarantee that it will be the death of you at some point. One thing you can do to help alleviate this is to buy and bless an ankh with your dew vial. A blessed ankh acts as a safety net from death. You're free to play a bit more ballsy so long as you have one.

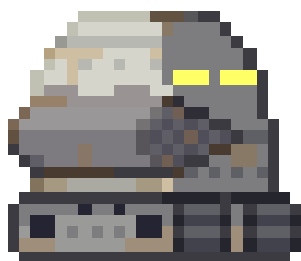
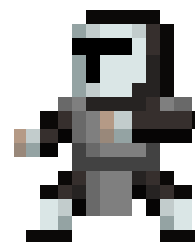
The final thing I'm gonna go over are the bosses. There are 5 of them and so long as you're adequately prepared you shouldn't have much trouble with them. There's an alchemy pot in every chapter so try to keep the boss in mind while you're there.



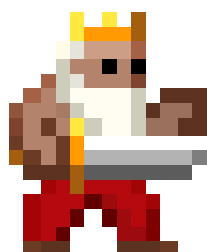
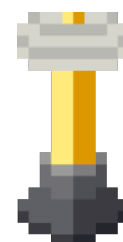
First there's the **Goo**. It heals over water, though water is also necessary for you to wash off its caustic ooze. You need some for yourself but try your best to keep the boss out of it. The only other thing you really need to know when fighting it is how to evade its pump attack.

When you see it beginning its charge, back away out of the radius. You can also cancel its charge attack by breaking its line of sight as if you were going to perform a sneak attack. This will be necessary if you're fighting it with a spear. If your PTI is less than half full, attacking will take 2 turns instead of 1. So make sure you're in a position where you can break sight next turn. If you're ill-equipped to fight, fire can be quite effective. Especially if you can kite it away from water and through doors/grass to keep it ablaze. In fact, fire is quite effective against pretty much every boss.

The **Tengu** is probably the easiest out of the 5. Ranged attacks are highly preferable against him as they leave far less opportunities for you to walk over his traps or for him to attack you. If you have sufficient ranged damage, a seed of earthroot or potion of shrouding fog can provide excellent protection in the first phase. In the second phase, if you can get enough damage on him upfront, he'll quickly resort to exclusively using his abilities. Which are all fairly easy to avoid. Paralytic potions/darts or shock bombs can help accomplish this particularly well.



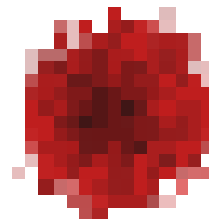
The **DM-300** can't fit through corridors. Kite it through them whenever you need to escape it. Try not to hug the walls as it will often lead to its rockfall attacks being unavoidable. Once it gets close to $\frac{2}{3}$ and $\frac{1}{3}$ health remaining you want to make sure you're near the walls in the center of the arena. It'll enter a period of invulnerability at those health increments where it can move twice as fast and plow through walls! This however greatly slows it so cutting through the center of the arena is a great way to lose it. You can use items as well of course but the map is always preferable considering it's free. If you are to use items though, know that it resists just about any negative effect that may help you to avoid it. Lean towards those that it can't resist such as stones of flock/blink, potions of haste/invisibility or the phase shift spell. In order to make it vulnerable again you must destroy the correct power pylon hidden in one of the corners of the arena. Watch where the sparks are gravitating towards. They'll point you towards the active pylon.



The **Dwarf King** spawns enemies throughout 3 phases as you fight him. Though they all collapse after each one. First phase you battle the king and his minions, second he becomes invulnerable until you defeat 3 waves of enemies and in the third you just want to rush to get enough damage on him before the whole room is completely filled with his undead army. Any AoE potions, scrolls, brews or bombs are quite effective at thinning out the swarms. Stones of aggression can turn his minions against each other or even the king himself, especially useful during the final phase. If you don't have a stone of aggression you're probably going to at least want to save a potion of invisibility or some cloak charges for the final phase as he takes all damage in a heavily deferred manner during it.

A few of my particular favorite crafts for this fight include the elixir of toxic essence, potion of stamina, scroll of dread and the wild energy spell. There's far more loot in the Demon Halls than any other chapter so no need to be stingy with your item use here.

Yog-Dweza will replace a larva with a ripper demon for each demon spawner you left active. These rippers make the final fight incredibly more difficult so destroying the portals is strongly recommended. There's a total of 4 of them, 1 on each depth of the chapter. Damaging the eye itself is then easy as the larva are a non-issue compared to rippers. If your armor is still too weak then your 2 best options for damaging it safely are the Huntress' spirit bow or stones of aggression. Wands can be good too but they can quickly run out of charge against such a massive amount of HP.



After taking sufficient damage there are 3 pairs of fists that Yog may summon from. You'll be facing 1 from each pair. Remember all fists are completely invulnerable while in the center of the stage so don't bother attacking them there. I'll briefly cover how best to counter each one. And as a quick reminder, this is the final boss. Meaning any items you may have left are about to become useless. So don't be afraid to send it.

Rotting: Like the Goo, regenerates HP over water and can give caustic ooze on hit. It also has toxic gas as a ranged attack. This is easily the least threatening ranged attack though as it's pretty harmless and will actually help to kill larva. In other words you're very free to kite this fist. It accepts all damage in the form of bleed making it so for the first time ever in the game, DOT is basically worthless. Instead you should try to periodically hit it with very strong blows.

Rusted: Has a ranged attack that will leave you crippled. However, it's considered a large enemy and thus can't fit between many gaps in the skulls allowing you to still avoid it very effectively. Most notably it takes all damage in a heavily deferred manner. One good thing about that though is that it has a much more difficult time snapping out of paralysis because of it.

Burning: Surrounded with flames and has a ranged attack that ignites you. This fire is also even capable of evaporating water! The elixir of dragon's blood can grant temporary immunity to being set ablaze but apart from that I don't have much else to say. Keep finding more water or evade its attacks.

Soiled: Sprouts vegetation that greatly shields it from damage and it can see through. It also has a ranged attack that roots. Any extra potions of levitation you may have left can grant immunity to its roots. Though don't panic if rooted while Yog's lasers are targeting you. For whatever reason, they won't fire until you're free to move again. Bombs/blast stones are particularly effective here as they will always deal full damage by destroying any adjacent grass. While fire might seem like an obvious solution here, it will actually do more harm than good. It does not take damage from fire.

Bright/Dark: Ranged attacks deal damage as well as blind/weaken your torches respectively. At ½ HP and death they'll teleport away and blind/extinguish your torch. Though odds are you'll have a surplus of torches and mageroyal can always cure the blind. Potions of mind vision/magical sight can always help too if you're still having vision troubles. I usually like to use some blinding seeds/darts for this fight as they're both pretty worthless once blinded. Apart from that, honeypots can distract them for a bit and scrolls of anti-magic offer a lot of protection. Though they render your own wands useless as well.



After defeating all 3 fists Yog has one last desperation phase where the lasers and spawns become quite rapid. This is easily countered by DOT such as toxic/corrosion gas and/or an infernal brew. Best thrown toward the eye either immediately after or just before defeating the final fist. Invisibility/haste can be quite useful here as well as aggression stones once again.

TL/DR: Don't die

If you enjoyed my guide then read on because it's nowhere near over! There are 6 more chapters which cover:

↑ **I: The Basics**

🗺 **II: Using the Dungeon**

👁 **III: Uncovering Secrets**

❓ **IV: Identifying Items**

📖 **V: The Powers of Wands**

👹 **VI: Fighting Enemies**

🏹 **VII: Challenges**



Shattered Pixel Dungeon the Complete Newb Adventurer's Guide

Chapter II: Using the Dungeon

 v3.0.0



- [Original Reddit Post](#) - [Original Reddit Post](#) -

This chapter is going to be dedicated to using the dungeon layout to get the best of enemies. Starting with positions and angles in which you can shoot a ranged enemy/trap without them being able to return fire. If you ever wonder how I effectively kill enemies such as dwarf warlocks in all-challenge runs, this is a large part of it. Now you can always use grass as cover or, provided there's enough room, break their line of sight through sheer distance. But those are hardly the only ways. With good positioning there are many opportunities for some one-sided shootouts.



Angle A: I can trigger that trap without it being able to fire back. It's basically the PD equivalent of the shoulder advantage in shooting games. This angle can hit deeper as well by stepping back. For each tile I step back I can shoot 1 tile further. The dots on the top are where I'd have to stand to hit my target represented by the matching color dot on the bottom. For the most part you're only going to be using the shortest version of this angle (hero's current position). But knowing the rest is still important for:

-  The occasional time you'll use it to get a free zap on an enemy.
-  Knowing the angle to safely disarm ranged traps. Seriously, you can disarm a full path through a trap room with this provided you have enough space to back up. In fact, I'm so confident in this knowledge that I don't even hesitate to use it on grim traps!
-  Recognizing if an enemy (or trap) can or cannot zap you when they have a similar position themselves. Enemies and traps follow this same rule.

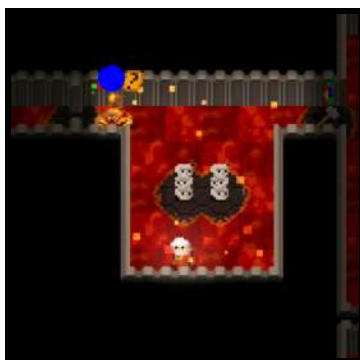


Angle B: The opposite side of the first angle. I can't naturally hit with this one so I'll need to manually aim. Often referred to as a trickshot by many players. To hit tap 1 tile past your target for every tile between you and them. Dots on the top are where I'd have to tap to hit my target while standing on the matching color dot on the bottom. Beware though, if there's only 1 tile of space between the both of you, they'll still be able to zap you! But as long as there's at least 2, you'll be both out of range and sight of your target.

Something to keep in mind when disarming ranged traps: If you're ever aiming past one to disarm it, such as with this angle, you'll need a wall or something for an item to collide with in order for it to actually stop and land on said trap. This doesn't apply to enemies because your attacks will collide with them on their own. This is probably fairly obvious information but I still figured I'd mention it.



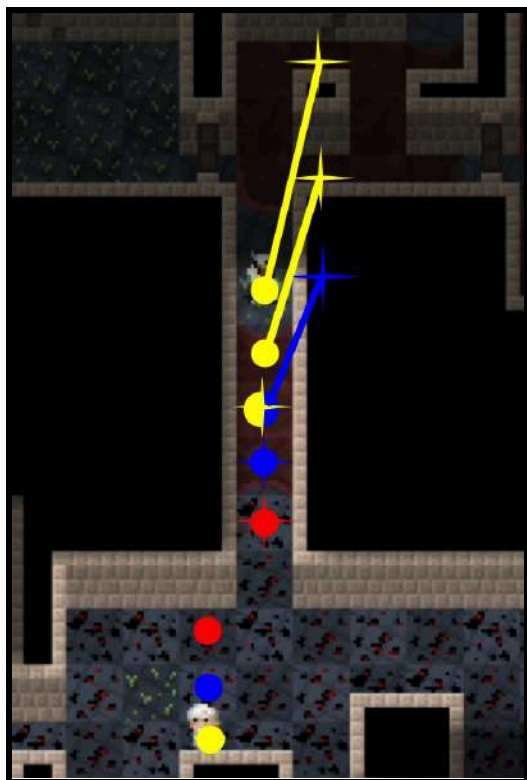
Angle C: To show that the A and B examples aren't the only ones I'm going to give a few more. Here's another one where I can zap but am out of range and sight of my target. This angle is like a choke point of sorts. For it to work though I'd need to tap 1 tile to the lower left of the shaman where the red dot is. You'll likely only be using the shortest version of this angle but it can still be extended just like the previous one as shown by the blue dots. While not quite as important as the A and B angles, getting good at recognizing the less common ones such as these is still quite useful.



Angle D: This one is interesting because there isn't even anything obstructing the scorio's trajectory. In this case I'm actually the one with it obstructed. I'd have to tap 1 tile above the scorio to hit it. But since I'm out of sight and can manually aim, I still have the upper hand. Because of this you can actually use this angle to your advantage regardless of which side of it you're on for different reasons. The top side lacks vision while the bottom side lacks a clear path. But as the player you can cheat both of those rules a bit. And that's what this guide is all about.



Angle E: (Red dot substituting for non-visible enemy.) Here there's actually nothing obstructing either of our trajectories. In fact, the angle is exactly the same for both of us. But only I can shoot without sight of my target. And traps of course. They don't care if you're within their line of sight. They only care if their path is obstructed. So be careful which angles you use to disarm them.



Advanced Angle A: If you want to try something a bit more complex, once you've stepped back at least 1 tile you'll be able to hit even deeper down a corridor through manual aiming. 1 extra tile deep for each tile you step back. So if you step back once you can hit 2 tiles past the shortest version of the angle. Step back twice and you can hit up to 4 tiles further. Step back 3 times and, well you've broken line of sight at that point. Now onto the manual aiming. You have to aim 1 tile to the opposite side, and then 1 tile up for each tile the enemy is from the shortest version of the angle. Dots on the bottom are where I'd have to stand for the dots of the matching color on the top to be relevant. In order to hit a dot I'd have to aim at the plus symbol that it's connected to. Careful though, once the enemy passes the first dot of the color you're standing on they'll be able to return fire. When that happens, not counting the utilization of various items, you can either stand your ground and fight them melee/trade a bit of fire or opt to retreat, reposition and re-engage.

Auto-targeting: I should probably explain how this works and when to use it. First of all, always check to make sure that you're actually locked on to the enemy you wish to be targeting. It could have switched on to a passive statue, piranha or anything else you may not want to be attacking. Second, auto-targeting will do the manual aiming part for you, but only if where you need to aim is within a 2 tile radius of your target. For example, in the image provided for angle B you'd have to manually target. But the ones provided for C and D could've used auto-target just fine. Enemies/traps however will never manually target. Nor do they have an auto-target to do it for them.

Do you need to memorize all of these angles? No, of course not. I'm just trying to give you an idea of them and just how common they really are. Memorize as much as you want to. You certainly don't need to turn your PD experience into a full-fledged geometry lesson. I don't remember or care to know every single possible angle in the game either. Realistically I just eyeball the ones I don't have memorized. If you think you see one then auto-targeting can usually do its thing. I'd say primarily just focus on getting used to abusing angles A, B and C as I will be using them many times throughout this guide. If you want to get acquainted with more afterwards then go ahead. But those are the most important and the ones that you should really be spamming the hell out of. Though for the record, I do know every angle shown in this guide by heart.

Next we're going to move onto how to reliably create space from enemies. I often see people talk about how you can use various artifacts, wands, rings, glyphs, etc... to make space from enemies. However I don't see enough about how the dungeon itself can be one of the greatest tools in the game when used properly. I see a lot of talk about a few specific things, primarily pillars and tall grass. While those are both great they're hardly the full extent of it. Learning how to lose enemies and gain space with the dungeon has helped me a lot in being successful. Especially to not constantly die in the Prison in my all-challenge runs.



Pillars (or donuts as they're called by some players) are very common to come across. Especially in the Sewers and Demon Halls. Most are probably already aware of the extreme cheese one can perform by circling them. When around one you can safely pick off most types of enemies by repeatedly using ranged attacks in conjunction with **Angle A**. They can be good for losing enemies as well. Only downside of them is that they aren't of the most value when you have multiple enemies on your tail.

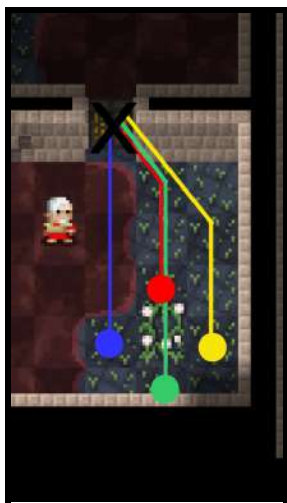
When an enemy loses sight of you, they won't immediately lose track of you. They'll first go to where you were. (Or as close as they can reach if something blocks their path.) But if they reach there and still can't find you, then they'll freeze for a turn confused before resuming a normal wandering route. Meaning they're no longer hunting you until you're detected by them once again. They only see where you are on their turn. Their view isn't updated after their move until it's theirs again. Below is an image showing where an enemy knows me to be on each turn. The Goo didn't see me at the top of the pillar because I moved to the other side before its turn came back. Since it reached the last place it saw me without receiving an updated version of where I was, it got the trusty orange question mark. You get the first move. In other words you're always one step ahead of the enemy. Just make sure that's not only literally true. It's important to understand this because it's why a lot of the stuff in this guide works.



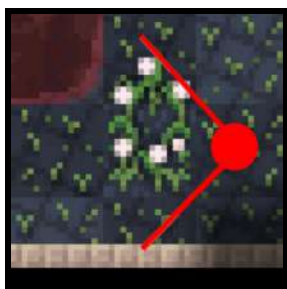


Should come as no surprise to anyone that tall grass is incredibly useful beyond the traditional trampling for seeds and dew. Such as being hidden behind to prevent ever being detected in the first place or making some of the most reliable cover for ranged attacks. It takes but a single blade of grass to block their vision. It just needs to be in the right place. The image to the left shows some of the various angles in which you can use grass to block an enemy's line of sight. Most of the time it's just going to be a straight line between you and your target but as shown there are many other opportunities as well. 2 things though, A: It's important to understand how vision works. You (and enemies) can see 1 tile around edges. Failure to recognize this could easily allow the enemies to be the ones using ranged attacks without their target being able to see them. And B: Attacking an enemy will draw them to your location. This may be a good or bad thing depending on your situation.

Grass can also be used to create space and lose enemies identical to how you would use a pillar. Where possible, when attempting to completely lose enemies with a single blade you want to try and mirror their movements after they lose you. As long as you can keep the grass in the center of you both you'll remain out of sight. Finally, when playing as the Huntress you have yet another option for losing enemies available to you. That is, by running straight through tall grass as you'll be furrowing it rather than trampling.



Unlike pillars, grass only blocks sight, not movement. This may be beneficial in that it doesn't block your projectiles, but it also comes with a disadvantage in that it can be easily trampled by an enemy. If you're afraid of that you can always take a step back right after they lose you. I often do this to prevent them from being immediately drawn toward me through the grass. If you do not attack then they'll only move through the grass if it's in the path that they're headed. Which is most likely a different room. So you want to angle it so that the grass isn't in the path to the door(s). Looking at the image, notice how the green dot would leave an enemy directly in the path of the grass? If an enemy were to be positioned there upon losing you then it would almost certainly trample the grass. Remember that enemies lose you the second time you move around the grass, or the first time they do.



Most of the time this won't really matter as there will be plenty more grass to kite around. But there are times where it might. Such as the Goo fight. Whenever I really need to lose an enemy at a specific spot of the grass I draw a sort of tent in my head. The image shows what I mean, or at least tries to. The lines are the path you'd have to walk around. Where they're pointing, or the dot, is where your victim will be when they lose track of you.



Next, it's important to understand that having enemies lose track of you isn't like sneak attacks which work regardless of whether or not they ever had sight of you in the first place. Simply going through the motions won't do you any good if your target never even noticed you. They must be hunting you. Exclamation point means they found you, question mark means they lost you.

Now as long as you have at least 1 tile of space from an enemy, assuming a room is big enough, you can duck towards the corner to easily lose them. However, if the room you chose to hide in was down the path they were headed anyway, then they'll just walk forward and likely spot you again. Which isn't much fun. If however the room is **not** in the path of their patrol, then you've just lost yourself an enemy! The odds of them turning around thus depend on the type of room you're hiding in. The rarer the room is patrolled the better. Rooms such as shops or gardens for example I find to be very safe options. Rooms with multiple entrances, those aren't exactly as reliable. Get familiar with this one as it will likely be your most commonly used method to lose enemies.

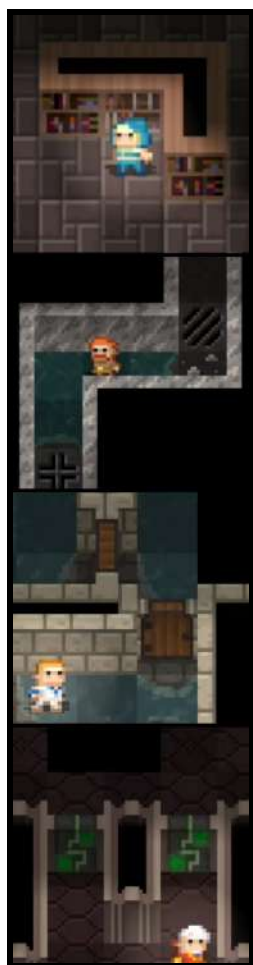
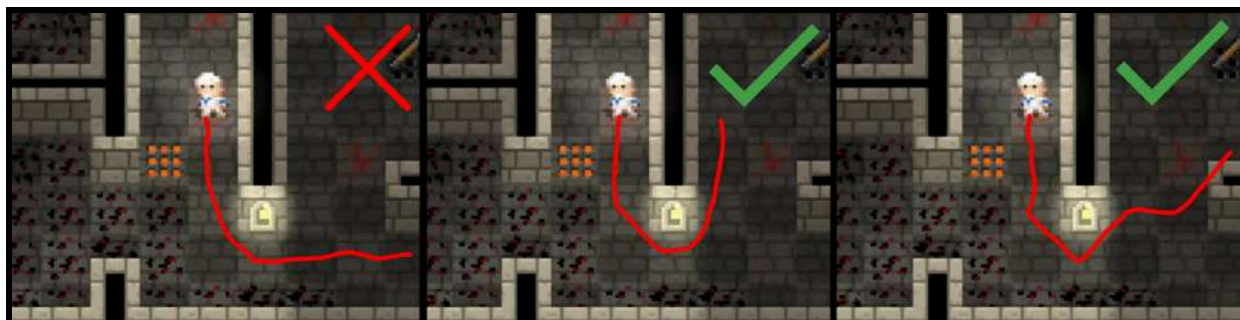


Now attacking an enemy while they have the orange question mark will immediately draw them back to you again. You did gain space, so it's still a free (sneak) attack. Unless however, if you manage to strike them before the question mark appears, then they will still lose you despite the attack.

If your intention is to lose an enemy entirely and they went the same direction that you're headed, then you may want to wait a bit so that you aren't immediately spotted again upon exiting. Particularly until you see a door open and close on the map if you can. Even if you plan to re-engage the enemy you should still wait a few turns if possible to create some additional space.

While that was the basic way, it's hardly the only way to lose enemies through rooms. Gardens can work regardless of their size through their shadowmeld effect and don't even require any space from the enemy to do it! Bookshelf rooms, both regular and secret, can work despite their awkward shape. Same as many Caves rooms. These just better resemble **Angle C** while the more simple rooms resemble **Angle B**.

You can perform the same trick inside of a room using random inner walls. You'll find a lot of nice straight ones in the Prison and Dwarf Metropolis. Though losing enemies with these straight walls only works when going around a wall. It won't work if you just go up it. A door is needed to block their vision in that case. This works without the door by using the front most tile of the wall to block their vision instead. Remember what I said about (enemies) being able to see one tile around edges? Image below shows when it does and doesn't work.



You can lose enemies with various other inner walls as well. A few examples are those found within the bookshelf rooms, if they're small enough those ring-like sewer rooms, the many random walls found within those large Cave rooms or the ruin-like areas of the Demon Halls. Generally something is good to use as long as you can wrap around to the opposite side in time.

Quickly moving through multiple doors is another way to lose enemies. If there's only 1 tile between the doors it doesn't even require any space from the enemy for it to work. It also doesn't matter if the doors are connected diagonally. And with space comes many more opportunities. A tile of space is needed for every additional tile the doors are apart. When the doors are in a straight line from one another, such as in the bottom image, only one door is actually necessary. The second one just often happens to be there.

Twisty corridors are great for losing enemies too. You may notice that the corridor in the second image resembles **Angle E**. That's kind of how a lot of this stuff works. The trickshot knowledge really goes hand in hand. It's all about understanding the core idea and why it works. Then you'll start seeing opportunities in a ton of different places. Just as sneak attacks were never about luring an enemy through a door, losing enemies isn't about any particular wall shape. It's about keeping the enemy from getting an update on where you are long enough for them to reach the last place that they saw you.

Now onto some tricks for tracking enemies and details about their AI. When an enemy tramples grass you'll be able to see it change on the map even if you're nowhere near it. You may also notice doors randomly open and close. If you pay attention you can use this information to prepare for an enemy you otherwise wouldn't have seen coming. That door could be the difference between sniping an enemy from a mile away and getting caught by a ranged one right in the center of a room. One useful example is the Sewers mini-boss. You can often get an idea of where they might be located by waiting while watching doors open and close.

Enemies will always take the shortest route to their destination. They'll start by moving in straight lines, then diagonally only when it means reaching their destination sooner. That is until they spot you. When hunting they instead prefer to replicate your movement if and as they see it. Keep in mind though they only see where you are at the beginning of their turn. For example, when you move through a door, they won't be able to see which tile you move to afterwards. Thus they'll always move straight.

Another example is when you have elevated speed (or your enemy has reduced speed). They won't be able to see where you move to within a partial turn. Meaning that unless you're moving in a straight line anyway, skipping over a tile will break them off from mimicking your movement. If you ever need to avoid an enemy not replicating your movement for whatever reason, you can either spend a turn doing something else or wait whenever you are able to act without them doing so. Another quirk of elevated speed is that you can lose an enemy if you line up your PTI so that your free move lands on the door. This makes it so that they never actually see you move into the door. To them you just disappear. Realistically speaking though you'll be doing this by accident more often than not.

Finally, I'm going to say a few random things on traps:

- Traps which produce electricity can be used to recharge wands by throwing them within the field. Just don't stack them on the same tile as only the topmost one will benefit. And watch for water as electricity will spread through it instantly.
- Enemies won't path over revealed traps. Unrevealed ones on the other hand they can path over just fine somehow. Point is this can heavily impact the way they move if there's no other (quick) way around. A ground melee enemy is helpless if traps block its movement.
- Ranged traps share the same vision range as enemies. 8, or 6 if the depth is darkened. Such as in the entirety of the Demon Halls. This means you can safely disarm them as long as you're outside their vision range.

- Ranged traps aim for the nearest valid target. Diagonal tiles being considered farther than straight ones. If you're safely disarming a ranged trap though, it doesn't matter how close you are or how far an enemy is. You're not a valid target. It won't consider you. This means you can launch traps to an enemy all the way across the room so long as you have that safe angle. The opposite is also true. An enemy who has a safe angle won't be considered a valid target either. You can also launch traps to further enemies through the invisible buff. Invisible targets are automatically the lowest priority, but still valid.
- Summoning traps can be beneficial if for whatever reason spawning more enemies would be of use to you. Sometimes it's free EXP and/or loot. Especially if they'll likely spawn off a chasm. Distortion traps as well. Enemies spawned from them can drop loot even if you'd typically be far too high level for that to happen.
- Unlike plants where you can still throw an item to trigger their effect on enemies hovering over them, flying enemies are unaffected by a few traps. Namely pitfall (duh), ooze and gripping. Flashing however still works for whatever reason. Though if you're throwing an item onto a flashing trap remember that retrieving it may be problematic.
- Not technically a trap but chasms can be used to easily transport your items to the depth below if your bag is ever full. Throw them down and they'll show up somewhere down there. Just don't throw potions or seeds as they'll shatter/take root. Stones however will not activate and are safe to be thrown down. Not that you'd ever have a reason to.
- Shurikens can be used to instantly trigger traps without spending durability. They can also instantly open doors or draw aggro on an enemy. And if throwing one on a fire/electric trap you can actually be within the radius and still have a turn to escape before it takes effect. Shurikens are sweet. Keep your last one at 1/X durability.

And that's all! I've tried my best to refrain from getting into things that involve specific items to keep this guide as general as possible. But the environment does make a lot of specific things better. Water makes many items and effects stronger. As do grass or chasms. Plenty of items have their own tricks that don't depend on the dungeon layout. I'm not going to go into every possible way to use every item, I've already made this chapter plenty long enough without doing that. But there are tons of tricks and synergies with specific items out there. Be creative and good luck!

Shattered Pixel Dungeon the Complete Newb Adventurer's Guide

Chapter III: Uncovering Secrets

 v3.0.0



- [Original Reddit Post](#) -

This chapter is going to be dedicated to uncovering all of the hidden secrets of the dungeon. While mastering combat is of course much more important and should be your top priority, understanding level generation and how to spot secrets quickly and efficiently can still help by giving you the edge in said combat. They accomplish this by supplying you with lots of neat stuff.

I've seen a few people say how you can examine the level layout to help deduce where a secret would most likely be hidden. Then search around that area in hopes of finding one. I suppose there is some truth to that. Especially if you already know that there is (likely) a secret somewhere on the depth. But to me that's too abstract to really be helpful. Then there's searching literally everywhere for every secret. That sounds like a massive waste of both in-game and real life time. On the other end of the extreme there's not searching for secrets at all and only finding those that you happen to stumble across. Given that many can be found with minimal effort I wouldn't consider that to be ideal either. So here's the way I usually do it and the way I'll be handling them in this guide. That is, finding secrets, but primarily through the more concrete tells that give them away. I can't help you to find all of them, nor is it realistic for me to do so. My goal will instead be to at least get you to stop walking right past fairly obvious ones. I know for the longest time I did.

I'm gonna start by talking a bit about level generation. Levels are generated in 1 of 2 ways. The first of which is a loop with the entrance and exit rooms on opposite ends. Meaning that there's always going to be at least 2 paths/doors from them. If there's only one then that means one of them must be hidden. This is also not counting branches. There may be cases where there's 2 doors but one of them is a branch of the main loop, not a part of it.

Branches are parts of the level that, as the name implies, branch off of the main loop. Branches seem to be far less likely to house secrets. They're also never more than a couple rooms long. So don't bother searching deep in one; there aren't any secrets there. They may however appear to be longer if multiple connect to each other. It's rare but sometimes they can even run a path through the whole depth. Which brings us to our next type of hidden door: Connected areas. If you ever see 2 separate areas adjacent to one another then there could be a hidden door connecting them. It may be worth a search if you could use the extra route. This is most common between a room and a corridor, but it can occasionally apply to 2 rooms as well. Though you're not going to skip halfway across the map just because 2 rooms happened to line up with one another. That's just wishful thinking.

Think of the main loop like the Goo's arena pre-v0.7.5. That's the general idea of what it would look like if it were to be isolated from branches. The image beside it is detailing what each area of the dungeon is within a normal level.

- **Red** represents the main loop.
- **Blue** represents branches.
- **Purple** represents secrets.



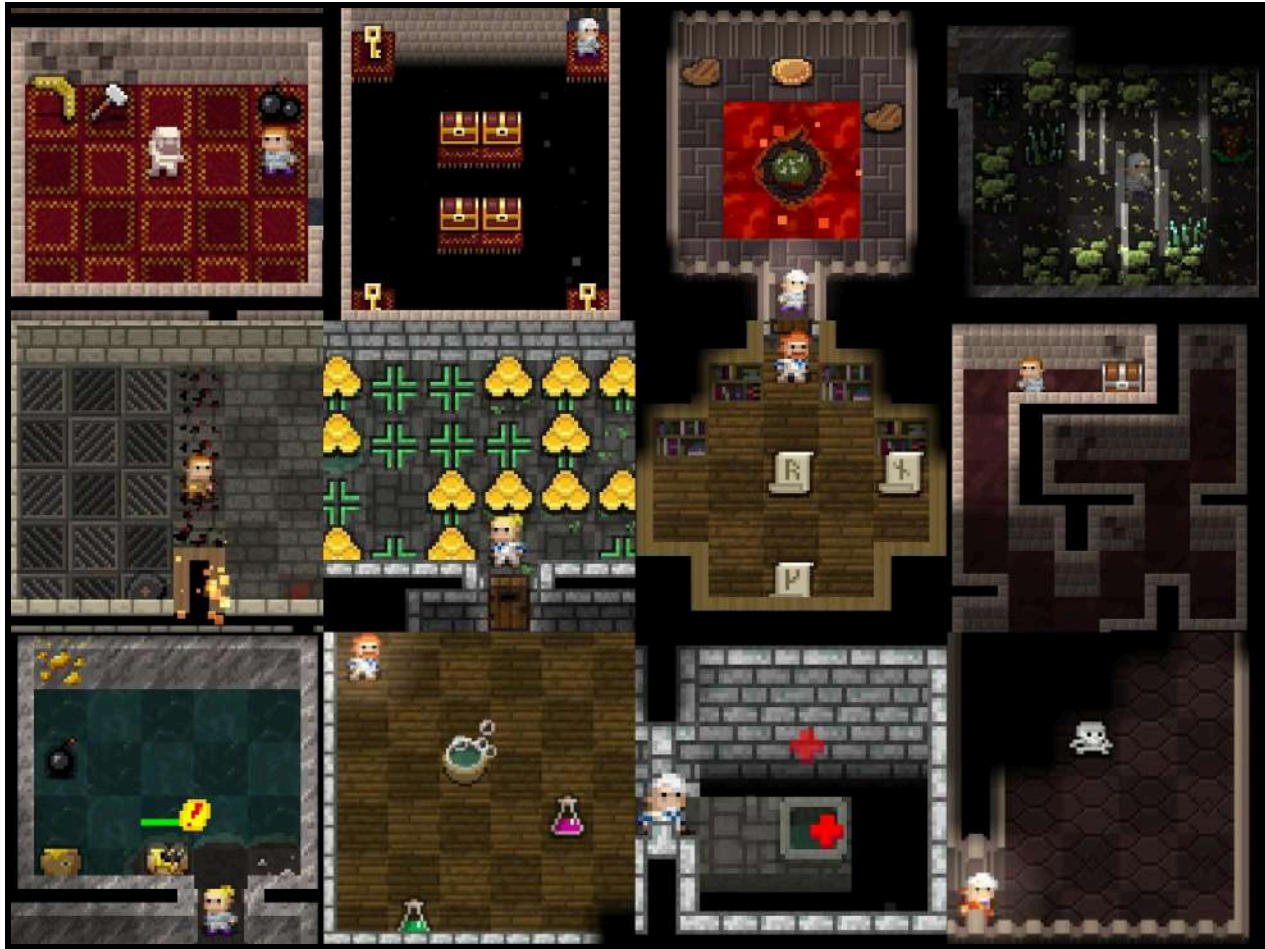
A lot of hidden doors really can be found by simply searching where common sense says a door should be. An exception is the Caves which aren't always very fond of common sense. That place is king of level generation that defies logic. You'll often find random dead ends there such as shown. Give it a search when reasonable but don't let it confuse you.

When searching you can skip over walls that clearly can't be hidden doors such as decorated walls or tiles directly adjacent to other doors. Horizontally and vertically at least. Diagonally is acceptable. To the right is an example showing where doors can and cannot be. The green area is good for searching. Red Xs, not so much. Finally, certain rooms only ever have one entrance to them. These include shops, gardens, puzzle, well, locked and secret rooms.



If you believe a level has been generated in a loop, then you should be able to walk a full circle around it without moving through the same room twice. If you come across a dead end room within the main loop then that means that either there's a hidden door somewhere in there or that you're actually located within a branch instead. When you reach one of these dead end rooms you can often infer which direction the loop should continue towards. To the left is an example of an incomplete loop. From the main loop I reached a dead end. However I know that rooms which are a part of the main loop will never be dead ends. And that the loop is most likely to continue from the bottom of the piranha room in an arch similar to the one drawn. The burning trap room is too far and sudden to the side, better resembling a branch. Using your intuition you can minimize wasted time and hunger as much as possible.

The second generation style better resembles Goo's current arena. It has a sort of a top and bottom or left and right to it with a rather large center room. It's not too difficult to tell which style you're working with. When searching these depths that large center room is a great place to be looking for some hidden doors.



There are a total of 12 different types of secret rooms that you may discover on a regular depth. All containing various different types of loot such as:

- 2-3 different potions generated with an inverted drop table and a pot with some energy.
- 2-3 different scrolls generated with an inverted drop table.
- 2 runestones with an enchantment stone hidden in the back.
- 2 stacks of missiles and 2 bombs.
- A blandfruit along with a pasty and/or some chargrilled meat.
- A well of knowledge/health.
- An uncursed weapon/armor with a boosted chance of being high tier and pre-upgraded.
- A garden with a starflower, seedpod(s) and dewcatcher(s).
- 4 golden chests containing random loot protected by chasms.
- Tons of gold protected by either poison dart, disintegration or rockfall traps.
- Bomb(s) and a honeypot protected by a golden bee.
- A lone pile of bones protected by an entire room of summoning traps.



A hidden summoning trap activates!

A few secret rooms have a little bit of protection to them. The first of which is everybody's favorite. If you ever come across a secret room with a lone pile of bones in the center of it, that's a major red flag. It's completely filled with summoning traps! Here you have 5 options:

- **A:** Strategically use items to kill everything inside to claim the massive amount of EXP and loot. Items such as toxic/corrosive gas, infernal brew etc... in combination with levitation/paralytic gas, stones of flock etc... towards the front to block off their escape.. There's also the classic psionic blast to instantly wipe them all out.
- **B:** Throw something inside to summon them then fight the entire army with brute strength.
- **C:** Just ignore it lol.
- **D:** Levitate in or disarm the traps to just take the item that's under the bones. What fucking weirdo does that though?
- **E:** Step right in like a complete dumbass, take a screenshot and post it to the subreddit. Everybody loves those.



Next we have the one that's filled with gold and traps. Technically speaking these traps are never actually hidden. Those on the bottom row however might be visually hidden due to the gold and wall completely covering them. Before looting make sure to examine the bottom tiles with gold on them to check for traps. If you wish to disarm these traps, you can deal with most of the rockfall ones rather easily by simply throwing items/blast wave/force cube from outside the room. The poison/disintegration traps are a bit trickier though. You have 3 options for them:

- **A:** Luring enemies in to eat the traps. This is only good for poison darts though. Disintegration unfortunately still melts your gold.
- **B:** Utilizing various items. Such as those mentioned in chapter I.
- **C:** Utilizing the trickshots from chapter II.



There's a small chance you'll be smacked by a bee upon entering the left room. Not particularly harmful but as in any circumstance you can throw an item to open a door if you'd like to be cautious. You can always loot all 4 golden chests in the right room with 2 potions of levitation or with 1 and other items such as a potion/ring of haste, hourglass or chains.



The total amount of secrets to expect per chapter isn't totally random and increases as you descend deeper into the dungeon. Playing as the Rogue grants you a wildy higher natural detection/search radius which will result in you uncovering more secrets than any other class without even trying. Especially if you take his Wide Search talent. Anyway, I stalked the code [here](#) to give you the total amount of secrets hidden within each chapter.

- **Sewers:** 2
- **Prison:** 2 (25% chance of 3)
- **Caves:** 2 (50% chance of 3)
- **Dwarf Metropolis:** 2 (75% chance of 3)
- **Demon Halls:** 3

This information is fairly useful to keep in mind when searching and can also be used to make fairly basic deductions. For example, scrolls of magic mapping and wells of knowledge will let you know for sure if there is or isn't a secret on any given depth. So if you were to activate either on depth 2 and not locate a secret, then there would 100% be a secret on both depths 3 and 4.

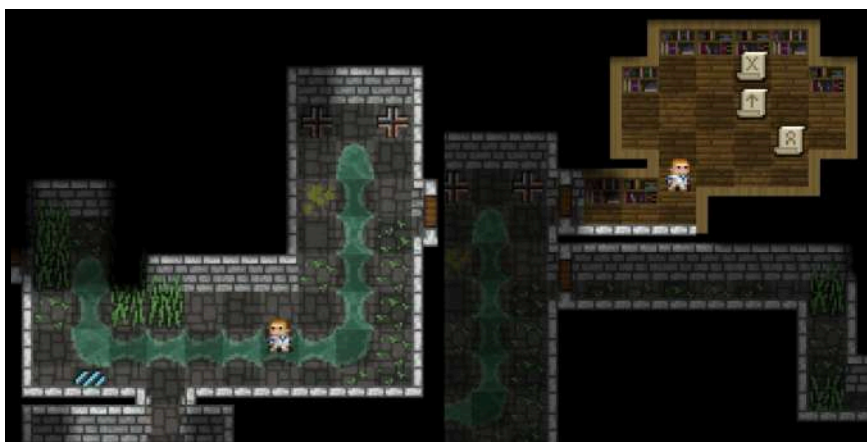
Now onto the various tells for finding these secrets. The first of which was actually already given back in chapter I. There won't be a tell for every secret but there's certainly quite a few to look out for. A well-trained eye can spot a fair amount of secrets that an untrained would likely miss.



II - Missing Bookshelves: This can happen in either the common bookshelf rooms available in any chapter or the maze-like ones exclusive to the Dwarf Metropolis. They're only ever going to be generated with gaps to leave paths somewhere. If you ever incidentally burn some down you can still spot the secrets by looking at the floor tiles. If there were a secret there'd be a special tile instead of a bookshelf leaving a gap in the embers.

III - Overreaching Sewer

Pipes: If those long sewer pipes have at least 2 doors and one of the ends appears to be hanging out leading to nowhere, then it's not actually leading to nowhere. It's leading you to a secret! You may notice that the doors are always lined up with the water rather than the



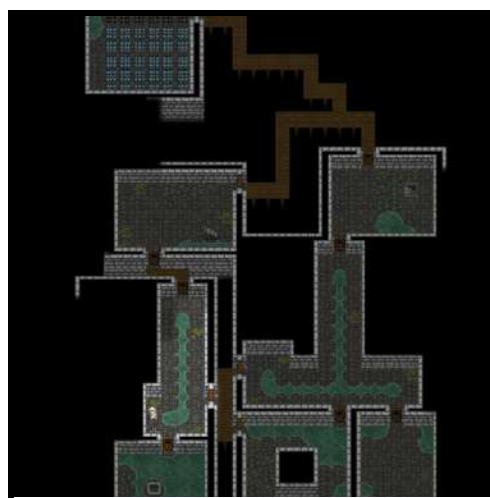
actual final tile of the tunnel. 1 tile past the door to let the water stop is to be expected. But if the water keeps running past the "final" door then it must not be the actual final door. To put it simply, the first and last water tile should always be lined up with a door.

Even if there's no clear indication of a secret there may still be one hiding along the outer edges of the room, but never the inner ones. You'll just be guessing in this case though. Not much better than a regular room.

Prior to writing this guide I was actually a bit confused on how exactly they worked. Thankfully **00-Evan** was kind enough to clear it up for me. I'll include his quote so you can take the opportunity to read some code in English. Great for me because I am far too dumb to read it myself. Especially level gen code. If I tried then the whole guide would most certainly end up being filled with loads of misinformation. So from the words of the dev himself:

"Basically here's how pipe rooms work:

- They occupy a certain rectangle space, just like any other room and by default are entirely filled with walls.
- If there is only 1 room connected to the pipe room, it will draw a pipe from that connection to its center point.
- If there are 2 room connections, it will draw a fairly direct pipe which connects those 2 connecting rooms.



- If there are 3+ rooms connected to a pipe room (regular or secret, it doesn't care), it will draw the shortest possible pipe along its perimeter which connects all doors.

So if you get a pipe that leads to nowhere, it's either because the room only has 1 connection, or it's connecting to a secret room. These sort of T-shaped pipe rooms happen because if 2 pipe rooms are adjacent to each other they flow together. That's what's happening to the right. It's actually 2 separate rooms. Pipe rooms also have a higher chance to be large and larger rooms have a higher chance to have rooms connected to them. So they're a pretty good indicator for sewers secrets."

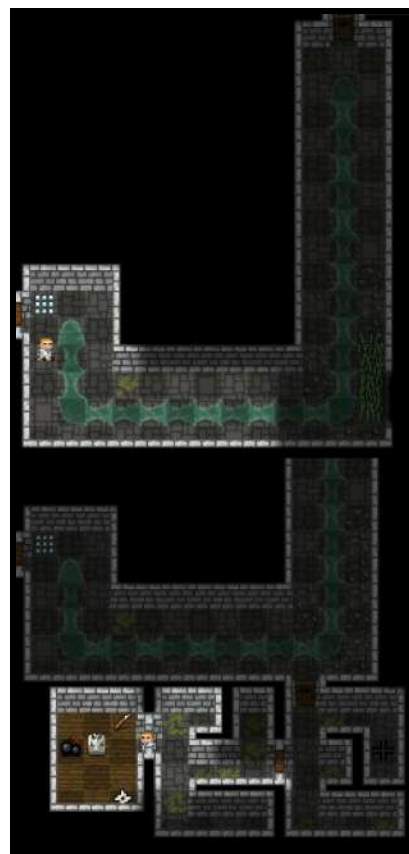
That explains it pretty well. Now I want to point out how this information can help us to find even more secrets:

- "If there is only 1 room connected to the pipe room, it will draw a pipe from that connection to its center point."

Here we can note that rooms with only 1 door must lead to their center point. If it doesn't then there must be another door, a hidden one. How can you tell if it's leading to its center point? Most of the time I don't think you can. However, I have found a way to tell in a couple cases. First is if it just looks excessively long. Second is if the pipe bends more than once such as seen below. Single door pipe rooms won't do that.

- "If there are 2 room connections, it will draw a fairly direct pipe which connects those 2 connecting rooms."

Next we learn that if there's only 2 doors the path drawn will be fairly direct. Meaning that if you get something really jerked off such as seen to the right, you'll know that it must be reaching to connect something. In this case it's clearly stretching far too much towards the bottom. So that's where I searched.

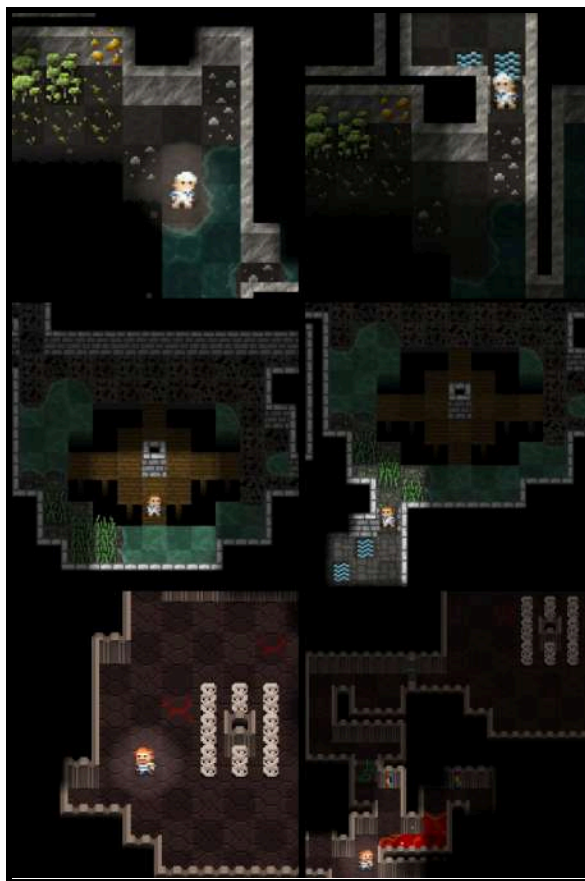




It will always be a single tile path. Carpet that appears to be doubled is simply 2 paths next to each other. It's also worth noting that the path will only ever connect to one of the corners of the statue, unless there's a door on the same axis. To put it more simply, if these red dots are ever carpet, then follow the arrows.

V - Pockets: This tell applies to 3 separate room types in 3 separate chapters. Those rooms in the Sewers with a platform in the center, those in the Caves with a large pit and those in the Demon Halls with the skulls. Some walls may need to be removed to clear a path to one of the doors due to their round diamond-like shape. You can check to see if any pieces appear to be dug out such as seen in the first example. Or, a little more subtle, if the corners don't match up. Such as seen in the second. Though nothing being dug out just means there's no tell. It doesn't necessarily mean that there aren't any secrets. Nothing needs to be dug out for doors to spawn along the flat midsections of these rooms. Except in the skull one. As seen in the third example even the middle is filled in a bit on those. In fact, secrets attached to those rooms are almost always visible.

IV - Dwarven Carpet: The Dwarf Metropolis has a room type that spawns paths of special tile to each door in the room. Following said paths can often lead you to secrets. They will always be visible so long as the room is big enough for the path to extend beyond the initial 3x3 that's always generated around the statue in the center.





VI - Random Cave Pockets:

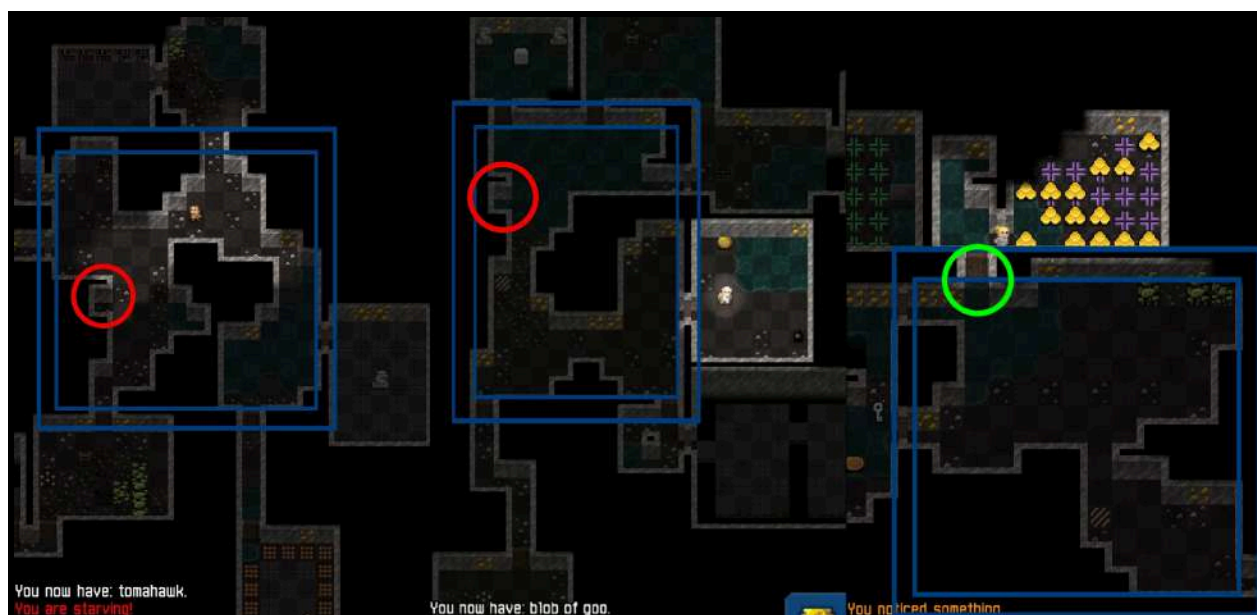
Additionally, pockets can give away the location of secrets in the other more random room type of the Caves. The previous tells were all consistent though. They didn't have any false-positives.

Unfortunately that won't be the case with this one. The Caves' naturally awkward level generation often makes it difficult to decipher

if a piece of the room has been dug out to make way for a door or if that's just the way it was generated. I can't help you to search with 100% accuracy, but I can certainly help you to cut down on searching areas that obviously aren't secrets by following *Da Rules*:

Rule #1: This kinda goes without saying but there needs to be sufficient space for a secret room to be able to spawn somewhere in the first place. The absolute smallest a secret room can be is 3x3. Make sure at the very least there's that much space open.

Rule #2: Rooms are always quadrilateral. Not just these rooms either, **all of them**. It may not always appear that way if multiple have been merged together, but each individual room was still originally quadrilateral. Only the outermost layer is able to hold doors. Don't let these gigantic rooms that are largely filled in confuse you. Identify the border and only search along there for doors. For example, in the image below I may have considered searching some of the little cuts in the red circles had they been on the border. The green circle however was indeed within the border and that one actually did yield a secret.



Here's another example of why identifying the borders of rooms is important. These 2 rooms were merged together. Making what would otherwise be a fairly obvious secret potentially missable. Basically all that happens when rooms get merged together is the wall that would normally separate them gets knocked out. If we add that wall back then the secret once again becomes rather obvious.



Rule #3: Don't mistake the Cave's diamond-like shape for pockets. Especially the smaller rooms. Remember, what we're looking for are parts of the level that appear to be forcefully dug out. It doesn't count if there just happens to be only 1 tile exposed on the border. You're going to be searching a lot of areas otherwise. What you want to be looking for is a cut in an otherwise elevated portion of the wall. Granted, I can understand how this may sound like the same thing. So below are some examples of areas I wouldn't bother searching. I mean, I did for the purpose of making this guide, but my conclusion is that it isn't worth it. They may be able to house secrets, but they don't look forced and thus their return rate is abysmal. You'd be better off searching along a totally flat area instead.



Rule #4: There should always be at least 2 tiles clear immediately behind the door. This is the minimum that these rooms must clear. This path will always run in the same direction as the door. Never vertical for a horizontal door or vice versa. Now looking at the image, you can see why each individual arrow is right/wrong:

- The **red** arrow is clearly pointing to the room's inner walls rather than the border, violating rule #2.
- The **blue** arrow is assuming a horizontal path can be cleared for a vertical door. As just stated this is false.
- The **green** arrow fails as there'd only be 1 tile free behind the door. As just stated a room will always clear at least 2.
- The **yellow** arrow is successful because it has a cut in an otherwise elevated portion of the wall, is on the border and has at least 2 tiles free behind the (would-be) door.



This also leaves us a new example for the pocket tells. When a path is dug out you may notice on rare occasions that a tile is missing from one of the hanging pieces. If you see this then it must've happened to grant a door its needed space. A watchful eye can catch the smaller details such as this.



Rule #5: The room will continue to clear as many tiles beyond the initial 2 as it needs. These deeper pockets are more likely to have been forcefully cleared and thus the odds of them being a secret are increased accordingly.

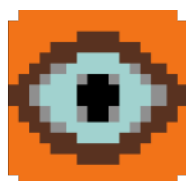


VII - Hall Chasms: When the largely collapsed rooms of the Demon Halls have a single tile path at least 2 tiles long it's worth a search. The longer the path the better your odds.



VIII - Cave Miters: In the Caves even rooms that are typically square will often have their corners mitered by having a single extra tile of wall placed there. It's far from a guarantee but it's potentially worth a search if you ever notice a corner has no miter while the rest do.

IX - Rogue's Foresight: One of the Rogue's talents allows you to know for certain if a depth hides a secret. When you get the message "**You're certain that**



there's a secret room somewhere on this floor." You can, well, be certain that there's a secret room somewhere on this floor. I'm super helpful. I know. I know. Please, no need to thank me. If you don't get this message upon descending then that means you have far less than the normal chance of there being a secret on the depth. Or 0%, provided you have it at +2.

X - Levitation Prizes: This barely even qualifies as a tell, but you'll never receive a consumable that wasn't forcefully generated as a prize from a levitation, invisibility or haste room. Generally this means you'll be getting PoS and SoU from them. That is, unless a potion was generated as a key to a secret puzzle room. The 2 secret rooms that generate them are the one with the 4 gold chests floating in the center and the one with random runestones in front of bookshelves and an enchantment stone hidden behind. So if you ever receive a potion of levitation/liquid flame as a prize then one of these secrets must be hidden somewhere. You can then decide if it's worth searching for.

XI - Secret Depths: There is a 50% chance that any given depth will have 1 of 7 different "feels". Each one has their own unique depth icon as well as a message given upon descending:

-  **"You hear water splashing around you."** - The depth has a large amount of water.
-  **"The smell of vegetation is thick in the air."** - The depth has a large amount of grass.
-  **"Your steps echo across the dungeon."** - The depth is largely open with chasms.
-  **"You can hear enemies moving in the darkness."** - Double enemy respawn speed and 5/8 vision.
-  **"This dungeon floor seems unusually large."** - Many extra rooms and loot generated.
-  **"The ground seems especially treacherous here."** - Many extra traps are generated and pre-revealed.
-  **"The atmosphere hints that this floor hides many secrets."** - Some doors that wouldn't normally be hidden are and, this is where we get to the tell, an additional secret room is generated. You're on your own for finding it but you can at least be sure that it's

there. It's also the only time a single depth can house 2 bonus secret rooms.



XII: - Exposed Walls: On that third depth type **"Your steps echo across the dungeon."** walls aren't generated without reason. They exist only in and around rooms. The openness of these depths means you'll often be able to spot the exposed outer walls of a secret room. Make a habit of checking for this before descending from these depths. Look closely, they're not always glaringly obvious. The first example would be near impossible not to notice while the second one is quite subtle.

Remember though this only applies to the chasm depths. It's normal to see extra walls poking out on a regular depth or on any rooms that are naturally largely filled in with walls. Such as sewer pipes or cave rooms.

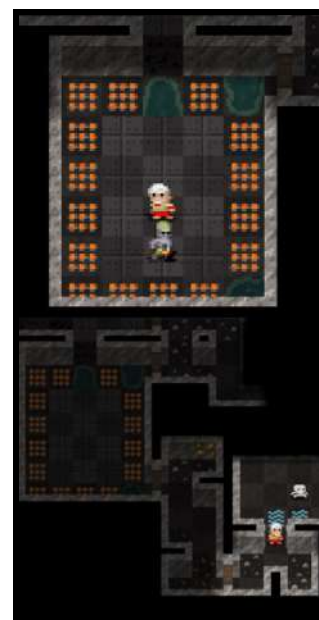


XIII - Goo's Nest: The Rat King is always hiding with his treasure somewhere on depth 5. His room could be attached to any other than the starting one. There are a couple tells that may let you find him instantly though. In the Goo's nest you may notice if the special tiles appear to extend past the final door or lead to nowhere. You can also note that the Sewer's signature pipe rooms are allowed to spawn on the depth and may occasionally reveal his location as well. If you ever spot either of these tells you can look forward to greeting his majesty.



Even if there's no clear tell as to where he is then you can always get the depth locked then lose the Goo so as to not waste any hunger while searching for him. Once found he has about 200ish gold in his possession for you to graciously accept. If you're ever feeling particularly lazy the little extra gold isn't really worth stressing over. It is however absolutely imperative that you pay him a visit anyway as otherwise you'll never get your run blessed!

XIV - Troll Blacksmith's Traps: The Troll Blacksmith is always surrounded by burning traps. If one of them is missing then there must be a (hidden) door there. And this is directly stated by him, but in the gnoll quest you can uncover most areas by digging around the walls where the boulders are.



It's important to remember that secret rooms don't have any special logic to them. Their neighboring rooms don't treat them any differently than a regular room. A good practice of finding secrets is to also take note of the areas that are already revealed to you. My point here is that you can effectively practice finding secrets without actually finding any. Look at the way the game treats all doors and you'll see that secret ones are treated the exact same. Picking up on the trends of visible doors is largely how I made this guide as they're far more common and you know, visible.

To end this chapter it should come as no surprise that the use of certain items can make finding secrets much easier. Items such as scrolls of magic mapping/foresight, stones of clairvoyance, potions of magical sight or the talisman of foresight should be pretty self-explanatory. (Though I'll still go over them.) Some other useful items include scrolls of teleportation, potions of mind vision and the wand of prismatic light.

- **Stone of Clairvoyance:** Maps around the target location. If you have a hunch where a secret might be but don't have the time to search all around, or perhaps you want to map out because you're in a particularly hazardous area/situation but don't want to commit your entire scroll, then this is the item for you.
- **Scroll of Magic Mapping:** Completely maps a single depth. Best used towards the beginning of one to also avoid traps and optimize your route. This applies to basically all of these but it's obviously most useful on a secret depth feel.
- **Scroll of Foresight:** Rapidly maps the depth around you for a period of time. The effect carries between depths and can cover a surprising amount of ground. Especially when paired with a potion of haste/stamina.
- **Scroll of Teleportation:** They prefer to transport you to a location that you haven't previously seen, including secrets. If the rest of the depth is already fully revealed it will have no choice but to transport you to a secret. Provided there is one.
- **Potion of Mind Vision:** Generally you won't be finding any secrets with them unless there's a secret honeybee room or a golem teleported into one. However, it also provides a rather small magical sight effect itself. If you hug the walls when using it you'll be able to see a tile past said wall. Which is enough to give you a small chance of uncovering a secret. It can also help you to find concealed regular rooms from secret depths as they'll likely be housing enemies.
- **Potion of Magical Sight:** Temporarily grants you the ability to freely see through any obstacles. Often resulting in secrets being revealed. If your intention is to find a specific item or uncover secrets then, like the scroll of foresight, it can be paired with speed boosters.
- **Talisman of Foresight:** Warns you of nearby traps and can quickly map portions of the floor through its SCRY ability. It's basically a high powered search that you're free to spam quickly and effectively. One lesser known ability of it is that it can identify the border of the depth. Its search won't extend past the edge of a depth. Therefore if its SCRY isn't reaching past a wall then you know you're at the furthest point of that depth.

- **Wand of Prismatic Light:** Its beam provides a magic mapping effect around it. Shooting it along walls can often reveal secrets. The longer the wall, the better your odds. If you ever have a low level one just sitting in your inventory, or even a high level one with extra charges, don't forget to zap it once in a while. Its secret finding capabilities are the same across all levels so it's always good for that.



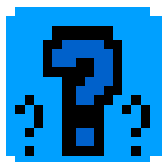
Shattered Pixel Dungeon the Complete Newb Adventurer's Guide

Chapter IV: Identifying Items

 v3.0.0



- [Original Reddit Post](#) -



This chapter is going to be dedicated to item generation and identification. Effective item assessment may not be nearly as important as effective item use, but that's not to say that being able to quickly and accurately assess the status of an item isn't a useful skill to have. Many items have varying effects, upgrade levels and curses to give reason to formally, or at least soft-ID them.

Weapons & Armor

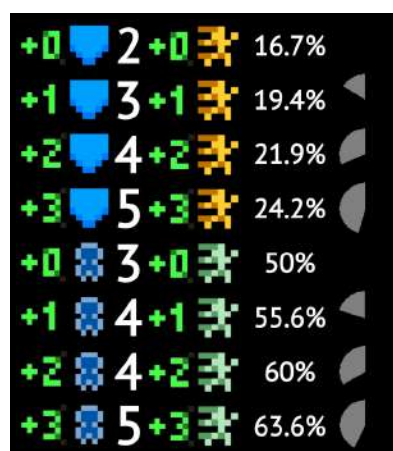
Naturally these are the first item types on the list so I may as well start here. To ID a weapon you must successfully land 20 blows with it. Armor on the other hand requires you to suffer 10 unevaded blows. Both require this to occur over the course of at least $\frac{1}{2}$ of an experience level to be successful. Unfortunately, potions of experience don't count towards this. As always though there are some shortcuts. First and fairly obvious is that you can feel out upgrade levels by simply using the item normally. This is especially true in the early game. Oftentimes it's glaringly obvious if the item you're using has an upgrade, 2 or none. You can also know beyond a doubt if your damage roll ever exceeds the maximum output of the unupgraded version.

If you would be only 1 strength shy of the base requirement then you can easily deduce whether or not a weapon/armor is at least +1. For a weapon, this can be accomplished very simply when playing as the Duelist by attempting to use a weapon ability. They'll fail if the strength requirement isn't met. Other classes can still do it relatively risk free by attempting to perform a sneak attack. If it successfully lands and you get the yellow sneak attack indicator, then it must be upgraded. If you miss, or even just don't get the indicator, then you must be shy of the strength requirement. As in, it's not upgraded. Another method is to watch the PTI. If it's moving, or at least more than it should for the weapon's speed, then you again must be falling short of the strength requirement.



For armor you can check to see if your movement speed has been reduced. If the PTI is moving when you do, then that's a bad sign. You can still check the level of an item if you're not just below the strength requirement by watching how severely the PTI moves. It moves the same amount for both weapons and armor. Image shows how much the indicator will move with how much missing strength. The image however is again assuming standard speed, which won't always be the case. Remember there's many different factors that could further alter your speed.

Rings, weapon types, augment stones, glyphs, etc... A glyph of swiftness in particular could very well be perfectly offsetting the decrease in movement speed.



The blocking enchantment as well as a few glyphs are consistent enough to easily reveal their item's upgrade level. **Blocking** provides 2 shield plus 1 per upgrade. **Camouflage's** duration is equal to 3 plus 1 per 2 upgrades.

Swiftness builds exactly $\frac{1}{6}$ partial turn at +0, scaling lightly with upgrades. **Flow** builds exactly $\frac{1}{2}$ partial turn at +0, also scaling lightly with upgrades. The round numbers make it very easy to tell if it's +0 or not. Simply move 6 or 2 tiles respectively and see if you end at 0 on the PTI. If you have more, then refer to the chart for your armor's level.

Stones of detect magic, apart from detecting curses, can also detect upgrades/enchantments! Though enchantment detection is useless as they're not hidden. In fact, it's completely pointless to use one on an enchanted item. The stones do not distinguish between upgrades and enchantments.

You don't detect any magic affecting this item.
 You detect positive magic affecting this item!
 You detect both positive and malevolent magic affecting this item!
 You detect malevolent magic affecting this item!

A couple more obscure identification methods are the Twin Upgrades talent, as the second weapon will display its boosted level. And the Dwarf King's crown. Rather than complain that an armor isn't ID'd it will take it upon itself

to ID any armor upon use. Though I have no idea what you'd be doing with un-ID'd armor this late in the game.



	0%	75%	20%	4%	1%
	0%	25%	50%	20%	5%
	0%	0%	40%	50%	10%
	0%	0%	20%	40%	40%
	0%	0%	0%	20%	80%
	0%	50%	30%	15%	5%

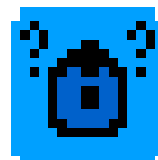
If one of your items is ever stolen, regardless of type, rest assured it's not upgraded. Upgraded items cannot be stolen. So don't sweat too much about stolen weapons/armor. Though of course I'd still recommend killing that clown for no other reason than having the sheer audacity to attempt to steal from you.

The probability of finding higher tier items significantly improves with each chapter of the dungeon. There are also several item sources which provide improved odds! Invisibility, levitation, haste, crypt, sacrifice and secret maze rooms, as well as the Troll Blacksmith, DM-200s and golems all use the next chapter's drop table instead of the current one. A few other outliers include:

- The Sad Ghost has her own probability chart, as shown at the bottom of the image.
- Slimes exclusively drops +0 tier-2 weapons.
- Shielded brutes drop scale armor $\frac{3}{4}$ of the time and plate $\frac{1}{4}$.
- The ring of wealth's loot is considered to be from a floor higher per upgrade level.

Rings

Rings are the only item to be ID'd based upon gained EXP alone as there's no way to "use" them. They ID themselves over the course of 1 level. But, if you're crafty enough, you can soft-ID them much faster than you can level up. There are many methods for checking for specific ring types and they often come with the bonus of even revealing the specific levels of the ring as well! So here are the 12 rings listed in order of ease of identification:



Might: The easiest to ID for both type and level. For type, simply watch to see if your HP bar moves upon equip or if it's no longer a multiple of 5. You can also check your hero stats afterwards to see if your strength has gone up. The ring level will be your strength increase minus 1.

+0		14.9%	
+1		27.6%	
+2		38.4%	

Haste: Simply take a step and watch to see if you're building partial turn. Just don't forget if you already have something that modifies your movement speed. I've mistaken an uncomfortable amount of rings for haste by forgetting that I had a glyph of swiftness. Image shows partial turn built per move. Assuming no other modifiers as usual.

+0		9.5%	
+1		18.1%	
+2		25.9%	

Furor: Quickest method is to toss a thrown weapon (or missile, as I still like to call them) and watch to see if you build any partial turn. If you don't have any missiles on hand then you can also simply wait until you naturally have to fight an enemy and again watch to see if you're building partial turn. Or at least more than you should. Image shows partial turn built per attack. Again, assuming nothing else is modifying your attack speed.

+0		1		6		12		18
+1		1		7		14		22
+2		2		9		17		26
+3		2		10		21		31

Sharpshooting: Provided you have a missile weapon on hand (or the spirit bow) you can check to see if their durability (or damage) has gone up. The image shows the increased max durability levels from your standard darts and 5/10/15 durability missiles. It's worth noting that the magical holster provides an effective +1 to your ring, at least



in terms of durability. Which is why the image is stopping at +3 this time. These numbers might also be multiplied if you have something else boosting the durability. Such as by x1.5/x1.75 if you have the Durable Projectiles talent or x3/x9 if you have an upgrade or 2 on the thrown weapon.

Wealth: Goes without saying that if you get a special wealth drop outside of the lucky enchantment then your ring must be wealth. It's actually not that uncommon for you to get your first special drop before ID'ing the ring. Especially when defeating a boss. The better the drop the better your odds of a higher level ring. Though it's impossible to get an accurate reading from that alone.

+0		14.76%		29.5%
+1		10.42%		20.83%
+2		6.85%		13.69%

Elements: The easiest method to check for this one is to see how quickly chill stacks on you. Typically 1 turn spent in frost leaves you with 20% chill, 40% if in water. The image shows the reduced amounts assuming you have no partial turn built. If you do, it may cause your numbers to be a bit higher, but never lower.

Arcana: Though I've never actually tried, I'd imagine there's a few giveaways for this one. Such as kinetic, blocking, swiftness, flow or camouflage being stronger than their fixed amounts. Or if brimstone starts providing shield.

Energy: The most effective method for ID'ing this ring would be to count how many turns it takes for one of your wands to replenish a lost charge. But being realistic, nobody is going to do that on the 1/12 chance that their ring is energy. That's a waste of both in-game and real life time. You however can still note that the recharge boost is actually quite significant. It's not too unrealistic for you to notice that your wands are replenishing charges quicker than usual. And it even modifies artifacts' recharge speed as well.

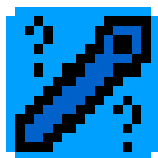
Tenacity: Tenacity is kind of difficult to simply feel for, but one thing that may give it away is the bleed damage from right after jumping down a chasm. Your HP will be low kicking tenacity into effect. You may catch it going for less than it should. Though this could go for any fairly consistent DOT really.

Force: You're not going to be unequipping your weapon looking for this ring. However, if you happen to be playing as the Duelist the brawler's stance option will be available even without identifying the ring. Making this ring a completely free ID for her.

Accuracy/Evasion: Unfortunately it's basically impossible to accurately guess these 2 rings. You'll never know if you've just been lucky with rolls or if you have a ring helping you out. These 2 rings and force/tenacity too for that matter, are actually far more noticeable when cursed. Especially in the early game.

Artifacts: These aren't going to be included as they instantly become fully ID'd upon equip. The only identification they have is whether or not they're cursed.

Wands



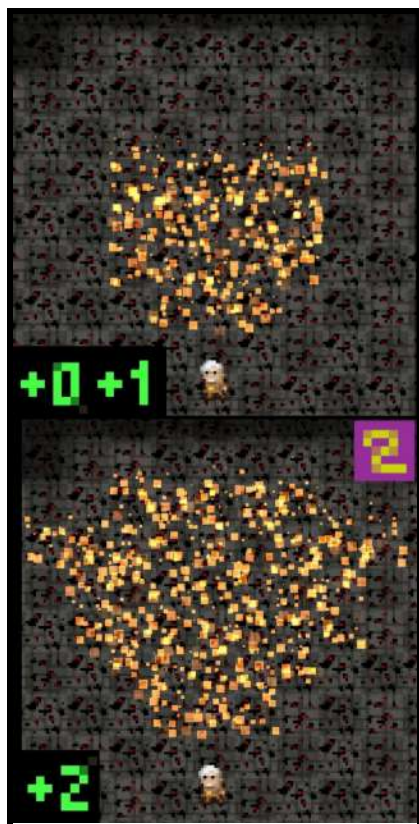
Wands are ID'd by 10 zaps over the course of at least $\frac{1}{2}$ a level. Though of all the item types wand identification may actually be the least important. This is despite them being among the strongest items in the game. The reason I say this is because the main reasons you ID items are to check their effect, if they have any existing upgrades or if they're cursed. But in the case of wands their effect is known from the start, curses are immediately revealed and aren't detrimental past the initial test shot and knowing the charge count of your wand really isn't all that important; There's no penalty for having your wand fizzle. They also have no strength requirement to be reduced by upgrade level and at least for me, the level in which a wand starts has little bearing on whether or not I choose to invest in it. However, it's still nice to have a general idea of what level each wand in your possession is and I'd cover them regardless for completion's sake. The easiest method of doing this is to ~~upgrade Scholar's Intuition~~ zap it until it fizzles while it's at full charge. Most easily done when you first pick it up. You can then add up how many extra casts it had. But this isn't necessary if you'd rather not waste your charges. Most wands have other methods for their timely identification. I'm going to briefly cover each one:

Magic Missile: You can watch for its magical charge ability. It's the same level as whatever it's boosting your other wands to. It's worth noting however that the buff will only appear if it's potentially able to be used. As in, you need to have another wand that is of a lower level. Though this also means that it can potentially reveal the level of a wand that you just picked up. If, for example, you have +1 magic missile and are suddenly getting the magical charge buff, then that's a +0 wand you just grabbed. One quick final note on this wand is that it starts out with an additional charge. So while 3 casts before fizzing out would typically indicate an upgrade, that is not the case with this particular wand.



Lightning: No special abilities that help ID it. Apart from counting its charges all you can really do is pay attention to its performance and watch to see if it ever exceeds its min/max damage. But that's true for just about every wand and upgradeable item for that matter. Either way the numbers that indicate specific levels are still shown below, assuming a full damage zap.

Disintegration: The only wand with its reach directly tied to its level. Its base range is 6 and goes up by 2 per upgrade. You need only zap it once with enough open space for you to count the distance it travels. This wand is unique though in that you can actually check if it's cursed or not without actually firing it! Attempting to use a cursed wand of disintegration against a wall will instead say "You can't target yourself!" while it would typically just cast through the wall.



Fireblast: You can easily tell when this wand is +2 by the size of its wave. If shot straight at +0 or +1 it will expend only a single charge leaving a 5x4 tile wave of lingering flames. At +2 (or 4+ available charges) it will expend 2 charges at once. Leaving a noticeably larger wave of lingering flames as well as crippling any enemies caught in the blast. Not to mention x2 damage.



Corrosion: Fixed damage makes this wand easy to ID. As soon as you cast it at an enemy you can simply watch how much damage they take on the first tick. That minus 2 is your wand level.



Blast Wave: You can watch the strength of its knockback effect. The center will push targets back 3 tiles plus 1 per upgrade. The edges work too, though not quite as effectively. If the edge is pushing only 1 tile then it's +0. If it's pushing 2 tiles, then it's either +1 or +2. Just don't test against bosses as they take half knockback.

Living Earth: Its buff is guaranteed to be granted upon damaging something and instantly gives the wand's level away. Just look at the armor required to summon the guardian. It will be 8 plus 4 per upgrade.



Frost: The duration of the debuff provided is directly tied to the level of the wand. It's 2 plus 1 per upgrade. Add a flat additional 2 if your target is over water.



Warding: This wand comes with the loophole of the damage value being stored in its summoned allies rather than the wand itself. No such thing as an un-ID'd ally so you'll get the actual damage numbers upon examining a ward. They're 2-8, gaining 1-4 per upgrade. Similar to disintegration, you can also check if this wand is cursed by attempting to cast it through solid terrain. Reverse **angle A** from chapter II is the easiest way to do this.

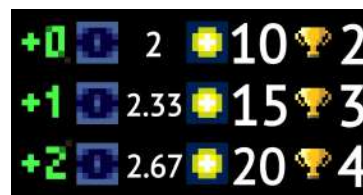


Corruption: Like many previously mentioned, this wand can be ID'd instantly by the strength of the debuff provided. Its base duration is 6 and goes up by 3 per upgrade.

Prismatic Light: Here you can again test the debuff duration. Unfortunately though this wand isn't guaranteed to apply its effect. Won't be long before it activates though. The blinding duration is 2 plus $\frac{1}{3}$ per upgrade. If the depth is darkened you can alternatively check how long it provides illumination for. It



should last for 10 turns plus 5 per upgrade. Or in the case of the into darkness challenge, 2 turns plus 1 per upgrade.



Transfusion: Pay attention to the amount of shielding provided. Its base amount is 5 and goes up by 1 per level.



Regrowth: Similar to fireblast, it will consume an additional charge if shot with 4+ available. Which can only happen if the wand is at least +2. This increases both its reach and root duration from 4 to 6. Otherwise it's fairly difficult to tell apart +0 from +1. Most of its power is tied to the amount of charges consumed.

Potions & Scrolls

		0%		0
		20%		6
		13.3%		4
		10%		3
		10%		3
		10%		3
		6.7%		2
		6.7%		2
		6.7%		2
		6.7%		2
		6.7%		2
		3.3%		1

Next we arrive at potions and their counterpart, scrolls. A very important part of accurately assessing which consumable is which is knowing the probabilities of each one being generated in the first place. Here are the 12 potions/scrolls, their probabilities as well as their corresponding alchemy seeds. Keep the rarity of each item in mind when making guesses. Especially if you have a large quantity of the same one.

Consumable generation uses a deck-based system in most instances. So these probabilities are actually enforced. What this basically means is that in 30 randomly generated scrolls you'll always get 6 identify, 3 teleportation, 1 transmutation, etc... before the cycle repeats. The numbers on the right refer to how many of each potion/scroll you should expect.

Using seeds to brew potions is a great way to aid in your identification of them; Each seed relates to a type of potion. You have a $\frac{1}{3}$ chance of brewing a seed's potion equivalent when using 3 different types. Not super helpful.

					16.7%		16.7%		16.7%		50%
					50%		25%		25%		
					100%						

This chance however goes up to $\frac{1}{2}$ when using 2 of the same seed and brings the odd seed's chance up to $\frac{1}{4}$. Your odds further improve the more potions you've already ID'd. Especially considering that potions which are more likely to be generated are in turn more likely to be ID'd. Your odds get another big increase if you know what the odd seed's potion is. Say for example, you use 2 seeds of earthroot and a seed of stormvine to brew a potion. But you've already ID'd levitation. Naturally if it isn't the resulting potion you can exclude the odd seed's $\frac{1}{4}$ chance. Thus raising your odds from $\frac{1}{2}$ to $\frac{2}{3}$. Now say you do the same thing again. Except this time you also have healing, liquid flame and invisibility ID'd as well. These potions are all fairly easy to ID so it's quite likely that this will actually be true. You also have to consider that even if you did roll a

random potion, it would still have a small chance of matching your 2 seeds anyway. And just like that you've covered half the spawn table! Leaving your odds at a solid $\frac{5}{6}$ for ID'ing the potion. Assuming it isn't already. That is also assuming I'm not an idiot who just failed at basic maths. Anyway, my point is that if you receive an un-ID'd potion from alchemy whilst using 2 of the same seeds, it's far more often than not what you think it is.

Using 3 of the same seeds in alchemy will always yield the desired potion as well as ID it for you! Easily the best option ID-wise for cooking with seeds. Just don't underestimate the value of your seeds' conventional use.

As mentioned in chapter III, secret laboratories/libraries invert the drop table. Thus leaving experience/ transmutation as the highest drop by a significant amount and healing/identify as the rarest. Keep this in mind when trying to ID consumables you found in them. That is, if you even note where they came from.



Enemies can drop any random potion/scroll through the ring of wealth's special drops. Though these special drops are easily distinguished from regular ones by the glowing effect that appears. In fact, the ring can actually help with identification on rare occasions. If you ever get a single potion or scroll as a rare (purple effect) drop, then it's guaranteed to be experience/transmutation respectively.



Another way to specifically identify these 2 rare consumables are the triple crystal key rooms. At least one of the potions/scrolls in the room are guaranteed to be either experience or transmutation. Though you may only choose one. You can however cheat provided you have at least one of Exp or Trans ID'd. Just open the middle gate towards the one you have ID'd first. Then, if you see it's not a rare item behind the final gate, you still have enough keys to turn around and retrieve the rare item from the other side instead.

There are also a few ways to peek inside without opening any gates as well. Mind vision/Magical sight, Wells of knowledge, Talisman of foresight, Wand of warding or even a projecting bow with the Seer Shot talent will do the trick.

These rooms are good for identifying more than just those 2 items though. In fact, they're far more useful for identification than you may realize. The items are sorted by rarity. Most common in the center, next most common towards the front and finally rarest hidden all the way towards the back. Potions/Scrolls have 5 different tiers of rarity. Which were covered just a couple pages ago. Basically, the item in the uncommon slot will always be of equal or greater rarity than the one in the common slot. This means that if healing is present it will always be in the center (common) slot or experience the back (rare) slot. You can make basic deductions with this info. For example, liquid flame being in the common slot would rule out the uncommon slot from being mind vision. On the other hand, liquid flame being in the uncommon slot would rule out the common slot from being invisibility, haste, levitation, paralytic gas or purity! A large deduction, made even stronger when combined with any ID knowledge you already possess.



Apart from everything mentioned in previous chapters, there's still a couple ways PoS/SoU set themselves apart from other potions/scrolls. They don't freeze/burn and they'll never show up in a shop, crystal choice room, secret room, tombstone, hero's remains, wealth drop, alchemy product (except through rotberry) or as a mob drop (except through mimics as half their loot is just regular chest loot).

There are 3 different identification items: Identify, intuition and divination. All of which are a bit different from one another. I'm gonna cover each one:

Identify is the most straightforward and reliable, but also has by far the lowest potential value. It's also the default state, the only one to not require you to reach an alchemy pot as well as the only one to meaningfully affect non-consumables. Generally I value consumable identification higher than equipment making this option my least favorite. I typically just use equipment without worrying too much about formal identification. There are however certain instances where formal identification is particularly important. Such as the Warrior's seal, Mage's staff, Troll Blacksmith, dried rose or arcane resin.



Intuition boasts a much higher potential value, especially in certain cases, but at the cost of reliability. It can be used to confirm your suspicion of a potion/scroll from drop rates, alchemy results or any of the various other methods given throughout the guide.

Correct. The item has been identified!
Correct. The item has been identified!
Correct. The item has been identified!
Correct. The item has been identified!

Or the opposite, confirm that a potion/scroll is not a certain one. Say you use one looking for liquid flame. It doesn't matter if the guess is wrong. You still know not to throw that potion at a barricade. You can fish for a specific potion/scroll that you're in need of or even just formally ID a potion/scroll that you're already sure of. Be it for slightly better divination odds or out of necessity for an alchemy recipe. Their value increases as you narrow down the remaining un-ID'd potions/scrolls Quickly reaching a fairly direct upgrade over identify.

Divination is sort of the opposite of intuition. ID'ing random potions/scrolls instead of specific ones, having the least control as it's largely automatic and having more value the less potions/scrolls that are ID'd as it'll be less likely to ID rings over potions/scrolls. While ring identification is neat, let's be honest here, that's not what you'll be crafting this for. It serves as a good icebreaker if you aren't ready to use intuition yet or a "lazy" craft if you have extra energy.

Curses



There are several items sources which will never yield curses. When combined with the Adventure's/Veteran's/Thief's Intuition talents these can also be free instant IDs! A couple of these even lack the blue background indicative of an item that's free from malevolent magic. Such as randomly generated enchanted weapons or



glyphed armor. There are cases where an item may have an enchantment/glyph but also be cursed (hero's remains, altars and crypts), but even in those cases the curse is pre-revealed. Essentially, an enchanted/glyphed item with a purple background may as well have a blue one.

Other curse-free item sources include:

- Invisibility/levitation/haste potion puzzle rooms and secret maze rooms.
- Shops, don't ever let me catch you buying though.
- Ring of wealth drops.
- Golden/crystal mimics.
- Tormented spirits.
- Summoned guardians/animated statues. They also both come with the bonus of having their weapon be pre-ID'd and enchanted in the case of the animated statue. Unfortunately though, the summoned guardian's weapons are never upgraded.
- The rewards from the Sad Ghost, Old Wandmaker and Troll Blacksmith. They also come pre-ID'd.
- Skeletal remains, while they still have the standard 30% curse rate, warn you of the curse beforehand. If a wraith spawns from one then you know the item inside will be cursed. Otherwise you're good, even if it has a purple background.



On the opposite end we have a few item sources which always yield curses. Sacrificial altars and crypts give cursed weapons/armor no matter what. Even if it's enchanted/glyphed it will still be cursed in the sense that you can't remove it. Hero's remains are the same



deal. Always curse the item provided the item type can be cursed, even if it's enchanted/glyphed. Items from the many tombstones that appear in regular graveyards aren't guaranteed cursed but still have the standard 30% chance. And the Ambitious Imp always provides a cursed ring. Still pre-ID'd like the other NPCs though.



There are a few more unusual methods for dealing with curses. Scrolls of anti-magic won't cleanse them. They will however cause them to lose their hold on you during its effect. You can equip and unequip as many items as you please while it's active.

Stones/scrolls of enchantment will override the curse effect on a weapon/armor as curse and enchantment/glyph effects occupy the same slot. They won't however remove the red background leaving you still unable to unequip the item. They're also both products of upgrade scrolls and thus aren't the most expendable items.

Upgrade Probabilities

		75%			66.7%
		20%			26.7%
		5%			6.7%

We've gone over how to spot items with free upgrades. Now it's time to move onto the probability of them being generated that way in the first place. Your odds vary quite a bit depending on the source of the item and are slightly better for wands and rings. Knowing these odds can help you to prioritize those that are more likely to be of a higher quality. The

standard drop rates are listed here. These should be the probabilities for any source that I don't specifically mention.

These standard rates are often altered. For example, regular ground loot has a chance to be locked away inside of a golden chest. The more upgrades it has, the more likely. This makes your odds of finding pre-upgraded items within them significantly higher. Consequently, this also means the regular loot you find on the ground tends to be lower in quality!

Invisibility/levitation/haste and secret maze rooms all give high quality loot. On top of the

previously mentioned benefits of the items never being cursed and considered to have spawned within the next chapter in terms of tier, they also have a $\frac{1}{3}$ chance of having a bonus upgrade!

		50%	
		38.3%	
		10%	
		1.7%	

		78%			70.3%
		18.5%			25%
		3.5%			4.7%

		67.1%			57.7%
		23.9%			30.8%
		9%			11.5%

NPCs provide some of the highest quality items you can find. The Sad Ghost and Troll Blacksmith have their own generous upgrade rates, the Old Wandmaker provides a guaranteed bonus upgrade to whichever wand you choose and the Ambitious Imp provides 2 to his ring.

+0		+0
+1		+1
+3		+2
+5		+3

The ring of wealth grants a minimum upgrade level for its equipment drops based on the level of the ring. It increments at every odd level. 1, 3, 5, 7, etc... If a wealth drop is at least +2 it will have a gold effect instead of the purple one. Note that these are upgrade minimums though, not maximums. Any level ring can drop up to a +2 item.

	+0	50%		+0	30%
	+1	30%		+1	45%
	+2	15%		+2	20%
	+3	5%		+3	5%
	+1	66.7%		+2	66.7%
	+2	26.7%		+3	26.7%
	+3	6.7%		+4	6.7%



Hero's remains give you a chance to recover an item from a failed run. Preserving up to 3 of its upgrades. If you recognize the item from your past run then you can know right away its quality.

	+0	22.5%		+0	0%
	+1	58.5%		+1	75%
	+2	15.5%		+2	20%
	+3	3.5%		+3	5%

Sacrificial altars and crypts, while their weapon/armor is always cursed, it's also very high quality upgrade-wise. This is due to the fact that it receives a bonus upgrade if it had to be manually cursed. A neat quirk of this is that enchanted/glyphed equipment from these sources will always be at least +1! As it couldn't have initially spawned cursed.

		+0	35.5%		+0	31.1%	
		+1	57.5%		+1	59.8%	
		+2	7%			+2	9.1%

Golden mimics have a 50% chance to upgrade a +0 item to +1. I'm not entirely sure if this is accurate but I believe one of their drops is a golden chest item while the other is a regular.

Whatever the case may be, the point is that golden mimics have very high quality loot.

Shattered Pixel Dungeon the Complete Newb Adventurer's Guide:

Chapter V: The Powers of Wands

 v3.0.0



- [Original Reddit Post](#) -

This chapter is going to be dedicated to, as the title implies, wands. Wands when used properly are some of the most powerful and versatile items in the game. I use them religiously. Mastery over them is crucial to mastery over the game. To say otherwise would be blasphemous. Almost every all-challenge run is going to rely on upgrading 1 or 2 of them. I'm going to try and go over each individual wand and how I employ them to their maximum potential. Though I won't be listing the stats of each one. That would be redundant considering the [wiki](#) already serves that purpose just fine.



Magic Missile: What for the longest time was the most basic of all wands is now the synergy wand. Rather straightforward, just zap an enemy and receive a brief boost to your next wand zap. Some wands benefit more than others though. Warding for example benefits greatly as each ward/sentry only remembers the highest level wand zapped and uses that for its damage. Corrosion has great charge efficiency giving it solid synergy. Wands such as fireblast or regrowth on the other hand have the bulk of their upgrade benefit in increased charges and thus don't synergize quite as well.



Lightning: The most powerful wand in terms of immediate damage per-cast. Though it lacks utility it's pretty spamable and can quickly melt any enemy so long as you can keep them at a distance. So as not to allow the electricity to arc back to you. Therefore mastery over this wand will be largely dependent upon your ability to maintain space. As was covered in chapter II.



Its chain ability gives it decent crowd control. While its damage is reduced the more targets it affects it's still an overall 40% increase to the base damage with each added target. This goes up to 100% along with raising the arc radius to 2 tiles when the **initial** target is standing over water. (You still have to be adjacent to an affected enemy to damage yourself though.) Notice the emphasis on initial? The rest do not matter. Whenever there's multiple enemies grouped you should always prioritize targeting any standing over water to maximize its destructive capabilities. Take a look at the comparison in a summoning trap room. You can clearly see our Mage **Chad-McThundercock** here needs only a single aqua brew to devastate one of these rooms.



One of its quirks is that it can particle track enemies. The electric particles that appear when you zap an enemy follow them just long enough to tell where they moved towards. This was particularly useful in speedrunning the old Tengu. Prismatic light has this same ability as well, though it only works on undead/demonic enemies.

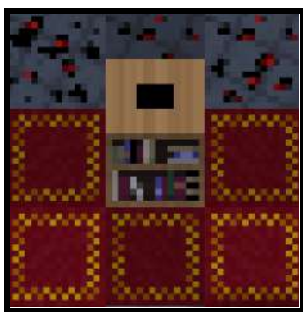


Disintegration: The ultimate sniping wand. Now I'm not trying to make a wand tier list here, buuuut if I were, then this would probably be #3. Only behind the DOT wands. Remember it's not to be used as a poor man's wand of lightning. Effective use means really taking advantage of its ability to pierce terrain. The best time to zap it is when you wouldn't be able to zap another wand. It receives bonus damage for every 3 walls pierced, **rounded up** before the beam reaches its final enemy. In order to use this wand to its fullest potential, you should basically be doing the opposite of what chapter II taught you. That is, to purposefully clip as many walls as possible before reaching your target. The most obvious example of this is when you're kiting an enemy around a pillar. Not only can you shoot directly through it but you can also take the standard **angle A** from chapter II and purposefully aim it a tile further so that it'll clip the pillar. That single tile is all it takes for an effective +1 to your wand's damage. If you're constantly positioning yourself and angling the beam in a way to clip wall(s) this bonus damage will add up pretty quickly.

Its damage boost is far stronger concerning enemies compared to terrain. Gaining an effective +1 per additional target. Meaning a stone of flock is an effective +5 to your wand! Therefore getting used to lining enemies up and angling your beam will be of much use to you. Easiest way to do so is to simply kite them into corridors. Though of course you won't always be able to do that. Depending on the circumstances you may need to reposition yourself, the enemies, the trajectory of the beam or all of the above. Just like I said in chapter II you'll be eyeballing any angles you're unfamiliar with. But how many are you actually unfamiliar with? It may be less than you think. Look at the top image to the right. There's a line up of 5 enemies. Do you know where to aim to pierce them all? The answer is actually quite simple. Just visualize some walls around them and bam, **angle B**. You just have to make the beam transition from affecting the left enemies to the right enemies at just the right moment. In this case done by tapping 2 tiles above the Dwarf King. Chapter II taught you how to avoid obstacles, but more importantly it taught you how to follow a path. Which is very important for this wand.



Now onto what really lets this wand pull ahead; Sniping enemies you otherwise couldn't reach at all through walls. Potions such as mind vision and magical sight, items such as the talisman, eye of newt, wand of warding/regrowth or talents such as Arcane Vision, Heightened Senses and Divine Sense may grant you the foresight needed to dump your wand's charge into whatever it can reach. Or, if you remember your knowledge of the enemy AI from chapter II, then you should be able to use it to snipe plenty of targets from out of sight without the need of such items. Anytime you know the location of an enemy. And that's pretty damn often.



One of its more niche uses is disintegrating flammable terrain. You could for example carve a bookshelf into a pillar to kite around or use it to stop fire from spreading to protect a scroll or even yourself. Unfortunately this also means you'll be unable to use tall grass as cover. That's alright though. Walls are your grass with this wand. And as a random final warning, beware of accidentally clipping the shopkeeper. It's not hard to make him vanish from afar if you have a decently upgraded wand.



Prismatic Light: Good for its illumination, blinding effect, decent damage against the undead/demonic and clairvoyance. Though that last one was already covered in chapter III. The illumination is particularly useful on dark depths as it will basically remove the need for torches. The blinding effect is great for losing enemies and can even let you freely zap ranged enemies. The proc chance is a little shaky but once it's established it should be able to renew itself pretty reliably. As long as it's at least decently upgraded that is. It's duration goes up in thirds meaning it gets a significant power boost at +3, +6, etc... Finally, the significant damage variance means it's a little weak in the Caves. Where there aren't any wicked enemies.



Corruption: The debuff stick. While it won't do any direct damage it will inflict 1 of 10 different debuffs. Weakened, vulnerable, crippled, terror, blinded, amok, hexed, slowed, paralyzed and finally, corrupted/doomed. Enemies are more

easily corrupted the weaker they become. This is determined by the strength of the monster, their remaining HP, quantity and severity of debuffs. Debuffs are considered either minor or major. For example, all of the debuffs to the left of the image are considered minor, while those on the right are considered major. Corrupting enemies is pretty simple. Get them low on HP with as many debuffs as you can then zap away until they succumb. If you don't keep the wand up to an adequate level then corrupting enemies is quickly going to become nearly impossible. Though the negative effects provided can still be quite useful regardless.

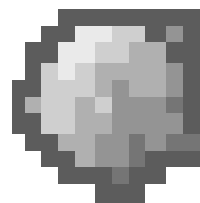


Something definitely worth mentioning is that this wand naturally has some synergy with other wands. Many can apply debuffs and notably charm and corrosion are considered major. More importantly though, soul-mark is also considered major. This gives the wand insane synergy with the Warlock. Some people might try to sell you some bullshit about how Warlock is best played by splitting your upgrades between a weapon and a wand. Fuck that. That may be how Evan intended him to be played but it sure as hell ain't how you play him. Here's a fun fact about soul-mark; The heal is taken **before armor**. This means that it has 2 major synergies. Low lethality weapons and low lethality wands. Both of these will work to maximize the healing you receive. If you ask me, the best strategy as Warlock is to split your upgrades between the staff (still use that as your melee weapon), armor and a second wand or ring.

Most debuffs are fairly obvious in how they may benefit you. However there are 3 that I'd like to specifically mention. First off, amok enemies will carelessly walk into chasms and over traps. They will however still try to replicate your movement so this may be difficult to capitalize on. They (as well as charmed if you have transfusion) also won't continue to pursue you after you leave their vision. So simply walking through a door is enough to escape amok/charmed enemies. Assuming of course they weren't pathing through there anyway.

Now second, oh man. Allow me to introduce you to one of the oldest tricks in the book! Been doing this since the wand of slowness in the Vanilla days. An enemy, when crippled, slowed or sufficiently chilled, can fall into a turn deficient. Meaning they spent more than 1 turn with a single move. This will leave them totally helpless and completely unable to retaliate. The trick comes in when you realize that because of this, you don't even need a ranged attack to hurt them as you're kiting them. Melee works just fine. Step back, attack, step back, attack, repeat. I call this slow kiting. This will work with any item that may inflict one of these 3 debuffs. They stack multiplicatively too. Meaning if an enemy has all 3 at once they'll take 8 turns to move. Leaving them open to 7 free attacks! Basically, it potatoes enemies. Just remember to check the debuff duration now and again so you don't let them touch you. This works in the opposite way as well. Fast kiting works through boosting your own speed instead. If you had, for example, both a ring of haste and furor, you could use the ring of haste to build partial turn by moving. Then spend it with your furor for a free attack instead of a free move.

This wand has one more niche synergy. If you already have a wand of corruption in your possession and the Old Wandmaker happens to give you the corpse dust quest, then you have the option of keeping the cursed dust for yourself. It will continue to spawn wraiths around you for the entirety of the game. So long as you keep your wand sufficiently leveled you'll be able to instantly corrupt each wraith with a single charge as they appear.



Fireblast: While it's no wand of firebolt, this wand still competes with corrosion for the title of best wand in the game! It's destructive as hell and I love it. Its AoE and DOT are absurdly strong if you really take advantage of them. The DOT is also based completely off of depth rather than wand level. Making it quite potent even without any upgrades. Still worth upgrading of course, but you get immense value even if you don't. Pretty straightforward to use too. Kite enemies through doors/grass to renew the burn, don't blast it near scrolls so as to not melt them and don't cast it when you have flammable terrain beneath your own feet.

You can torch enemies or whole areas from afar. So long as there's a path of flammable terrain you're free to light the trail like a fuse without actually engaging any of the enemies. Once the wand has 4+/7+ available charges it will opt to consume 2/3 at once and cripple/paralyze respectively in a much larger blast area. This gives it a little more utility as well as opening it to the previously mentioned slow kiting.

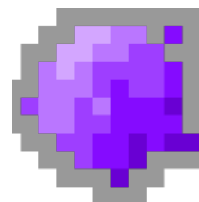
A couple neat quirks of this wand are that it will burst open doors and that its flames will linger a turn before going out. Meaning that while you'd be missing out on the direct damage of the wand, you can set up the flames a turn in advance to catch enemies who are not yet in range. One negative quirk though is that trick shots will often fail if the target is near the end of the wand's reach.



Corrosion: Just like fireblast, it sports both incredible AoE and DOT.

After all I suppose it should be no surprise that the 2 most powerful wands in the game are the most generally destructive and pose the most risk to the caster. Anyway, it's OP as hell if used properly. Key word being "properly". First off, that means to only corrode enemies, not yourself. He who can accomplish this is basically automatically in the top 1% of players. This wand takes patience and a little bit of common sense. Mainly you just have to wait a second to make sure the VFX has had enough time to appear when entering a corridor you previously shot in. Gasses dissipate much slower in tight spaces so they may linger longer than expected. That and don't get yourself cut off. Especially not with a cloud expanding towards you. Since corrosion applies a debuff, you (and enemies) always suffer 1 more turn of damage than what was actually spent in the cloud. This leaves a minimum of 2 turns of damage. That hurts. So don't fuck up.

One of this wand's greatest strengths is its charge efficiency or damage per-cast. If placed correctly a single cast can deal absurd damage even if it's only used against a single target. Excellent damage per-cast naturally leads to excellent charge efficiency. Because of this I'd actually recommend against upgrading it too hard or imbuing it into the staff. Not because it's weak, but rather because it doesn't need the extra charges. And at some point more damage and cloud volume just make it harder to control, easier to corrode oneself and more punishing for doing so. I'd probably go +4 or 5 at most. Wands that benefit greatly from minimal upgrades such as this one, fireblast or blast wave are also prime targets for your arcane resin.



Enemies take more and more damage the longer they remain in the cloud. Most easily done by meleeing them while keeping them on the edge of the cloud. Only problem is, ugh, *shivers* melee. A much better option is to attempt to lose enemies as covered in chapter II. This way they'll pause and potentially turn around and retreat back through the cloud. Combined with a corridor where the wand is much more potent due to slower dissipation and you can often pick off a rather strong enemy with but a single charge even on a modestly upgraded wand.

This wand shouldn't be cast directly on top of enemies, so fuck auto-target. The bolt will stop exactly where you tell it to, so use it. As a general rule you should always opt to place it where your target will be 2 turns from now. The neat part is that this works no matter where the enemy might be coming from. Another one of this wand's greatest strengths is its ability to be set up in advance. Kinda like just mentioned with fireblast but with much more freedom and to much much greater effect. You know an enemy is about to come around the corner? Corrosion. Enemy peacefully wandering or sleeping? Corrosion hit and run. This is one of the few wands that doesn't draw targets towards you. Meaning you can easily fire this wand without ever actually engaging with your victims. Guerrilla warfare and war crimes are what I've come to love this wand for.

It presses the tile it lands on. Meaning it can open doors/trigger traps and place gas at the same time. It won't collide with enemies, so don't get too fancy with your trickshots. This does however mean that it can shoot directly through enemies to affect a more desirable target. Including triggering a trap you otherwise couldn't reach!



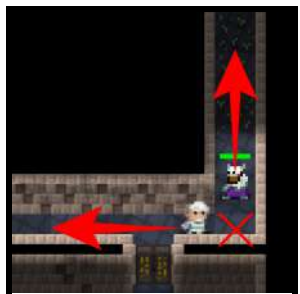
Frost: A cool wand that will greatly enhance your kiting abilities. Its chill can be used to create additional space between you and an enemy allowing you to safely abuse ranged, and as previously mentioned, melee attacks too. Of course there's always those pesky ranged enemies that won't be cheesed so easily. They are still however quite weak to this wand in another way. An enemy who moves significantly slower gives you significantly more time to reach and exploit advantageous positions. As once again taught in chapter II.

This wand gains power when the target is over water, adding a flat additional 2 turns of chill which equates to 1 more lost turn. So long as your target is over water, (or the wand is at least +2), its cast will be free or net positive turn-wise. It gains power on even upgrade numbers in that on every even level its target will lose 1 more turn from a single zap than before. Odd upgrades do however cause that additional missed turn to come sooner, making it easier to slow kite either way.

Its downside comes in its lack of spammability. Its initial zap is rather strong. Same scaling as lightning actually. However, chilled enemies take less and less damage the more that they're chilled. So you either need a second source of damage or to wait the chill out. Fireblast is one way to remove the chill. Giving these wands a love-hate relationship. Speaking of fireblast, another downside is that it similarly risks freezing potions. If the bolt collides with an enemy standing over one, then it will shatter. Not as common as fireblast but it certainly does happen. Finally, its chill may misalign enemies to the PTI. Meaning that if, for example, you're using a light weapon, you might not get your free attack when you expect to.



Blast Wave: The single greatest utility and kiting wand regardless if you plan on spending upgrades. Famously it can instantly kill ANY ground enemy by simply blasting them down a chasm regardless of upgrade level, albeit at a slight EXP loss. Even an armored statue or golden mimic! It's particularly effective on a certain depth type. I like to refer to chasm kills as dunking. And remember, America runs on it.



It can also be used to create space by launching yourself, an enemy or both away. Launching beyond line of sight is a great way to avoid ranged enemies' attacks. Most effective in the Demon Halls where vision is 6 instead of the typical 8 and ranged enemies are abundant. Launching each other in different directions around a corner is another effective technique to achieve this.



Targets take minor damage and are briefly stunned (very useful) when thrown into a wall. It's not the level of the wand that determines the severity, but rather the distance traveled before impact. The launch distance is much greater in the center of the ball. The edges only receive a boost in power on odd upgrade numbers. Though personally I usually only take this wand up to +1 or 2. Once it reaches +3 it starts to become harder to control where your enemies, and more importantly, yourself land. You'll need to start seriously worrying about throwing yourself against walls and self-inflicting damage/ paralysis.

It can be used to launch enemies/yourself onto, or provided it's at least +1, across traps/ hazards. Gripping/Flashing traps are particularly fun because of their infinite uses. It presses tiles triggering any traps before the knock back happens, not after. Except ranged traps. They do their targeting after the knock back. It can also be used to escape traps/hazards such as frost, pitfall, Tengu's bombs etc...



Regrowth: The supreme wand of farming. Though I'm more of a wealth guy personally. This wand is capable of generating dew along with many seeds, most notably sungrass. If you're planning to farm with it then those will be plenty to replenish hunger/combat damage. However, you'll quickly find it'll begin producing grey furrowed grass instead. There's a cap on the amount of green grass that may be produced. Upgrading the wand will push the limit until finally the cap is removed at +10. Only issue is that, do you really want to put so many upgrades into this wand?



Now onto the things this wand is able to do whilst keeping your dignity intact. Naturally, it can enable every grass synergy there is. Most notably it can provide cover on command. Its root ability is great for maintaining distance as well as losing enemies. If an enemy loses sight of you and is unable to advance to where they last saw you for any reason, in this case roots, then they'll instead freeze and turn around from where they are. You're even free to attack them without drawing them towards you as long as the roots are still holding.

Biggest downside is that it's completely useless if it's unable to grow grass over a location. Namely water. Though it also means it can lowkey reveal traps at times if there's a tile that mysteriously won't take root. It also likes to produce firebloom which can often be problematic, but can at least be overwritten by any other seed.

Like fireblast, it will try to consume multiple charges at once. When using 3 of them it will create a golden lotus. Which I think grants you vision around it? It might also let seeds activate by being thrown directly on top of enemies, give you a chance to get them back and increase dart durability or something. Idk, at least I think that's what it said. Who the hell gets regrowth to 7 available charges lol.

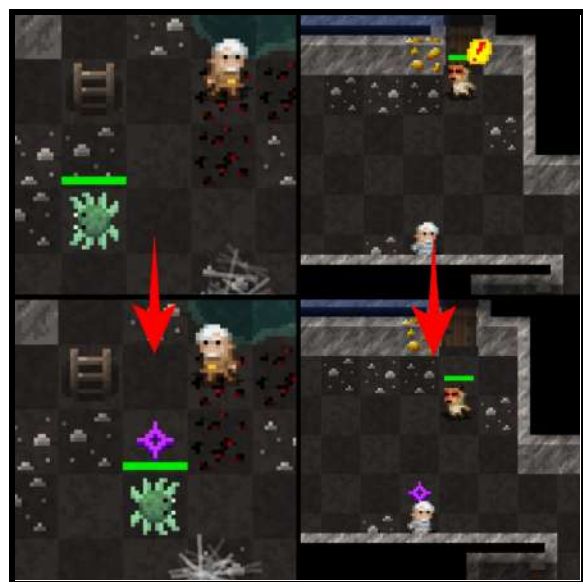


Living Earth: One of the rare cases of a truly defensive wand. Don't have a whole lot to say about it. The guardian is pretty straightforward to use. Throw it toward an enemy. If nothing else it's pretty handy against ranged ones as the guardian draws aggro on hit. Zapping enemies while the guardian is out will heal it as well as damage the enemy. So that's always preferable to zapping the guardian itself to heal. Zapping an enemy with the wand also causes the guardian to target that specific enemy. So switching targets is possible. This would also cause any enemies that might have been attacking the guardian to chase it.

The armor built from this wand can often be more valuable than the guardian itself. I often try to deal the finishing blow to an enemy with it to build up armor without risking the guardian wasting any of it. Rock armor is used **before** regular armor so it's quite effective at protecting you when your real armor is weak. This mainly applies once the guardian becomes too weak to effectively fight enemies.



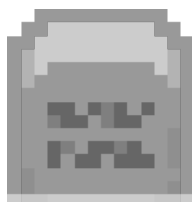
Warding: This wand here is the definition of being able to be set up in advance. Instead of zapping enemies directly you build up wards to kite your targets around. Always opt to upgrade your wards rather than building several. It's more charge efficient that way at least. Whether or not you build up your wards before an enemy encounter altogether or during a safe turn in one is up to you. Personally I usually end up doing the latter.



Wards (and sentries too for that matter) are fragile. So you have to place them somewhere free of danger. They're easily destroyed if an enemy spots and reaches one. However, once an enemy is locked onto you, they will never switch to attacking a ward just because it's closer. Thankfully wards do **not** draw aggro. Therefore if a melee enemy is hunting you, you can place a ward diagonally between you without giving up any space. Or if a ranged enemy is hunting you, you can place a ward directly in front of you to act as both a shield and a turret. Unfortunately though there are only 2 ways to get an enemy locked onto

you. Being spotted and physically attacking them. The first is easy with melee enemies, a little more tricky with ranged. There are still plenty of angles (or terrain, such as statues) where they may be able to see you but not have the ability to shoot though. The second however is a bit easier. All you have to do is land any physical attack on them. In fact, anytime you want to keep enemies off your wards, throw a missile at them.

You're not allowed to simply set up blockades in doors or corridors to prevent enemies from advancing toward you. Once an enemy is no longer able to advance toward you, they can and will switch targets and begin smacking your wards to get to you. If you're in a corridor then you must either place them behind the enemy, in a corner where they can go around or lure the enemy into a more open area.



Warding is great for graverobbing. It can not only block wraiths from spawning but also eliminate others as they appear. Generally the best position to grave rob is against a wall to block one of the wraiths from spawning. A couple other wands that are good are blast wave and (low level) lightning. If you wanna loot several graves at once then you can also consider a seed of swiftthistle.



Wards grant vision. This means if you're ever blinded, missing a torch or want to see what's over where, a ward can serve as an effective scout. Provided it's not immediately destroyed. When combined with how open the wand is in terms of where it can target; It also means you can support your wards even when you're not around. Wards can be placed on **any** tile you have vision of, even traveling through walls. This makes it easy to support your wards/sentries in a few ways. Most obvious is upgrading them but you could also trigger traps around enemies or throw lesser wards in their face to overwhelm a ranged attacker.

If an enemy destroys a ward while you're out of sight, then they'll freeze for a turn confused before resuming a wandering state. Just as if they had lost you. This might not sound particularly useful, but there are actually a few niche applications for this:

- If you're in a corridor or have an enemy approaching who hasn't yet spotted you, then throwing them a ward to kill will cause them to pick a new route. Just be careful as their detection rate is boosted to 100% upon entering the hunting state. So this will only ever work if you're out of their view or can escape it the next turn.
- Because their detection rate is boosted to 100%, you can drag them toward anywhere you want immediately afterwards. They'll immediately detect even a ward that is 8 tiles away.
- Because they'll keep freezing 1 turn each time they destroy a ward, you can continually feed them wards from out of sight to hold them in place. Thus allowing for free zaps from wands. Still eats your warding charges though.



Transfusion: What for ages was the definitive worst wand in the game now has a little utility value. Its charm has the obvious applications of protecting you from ever having to fight 2 enemies at once in case you ever find yourself cut off, protecting you from ranged attackers, buying you time to reposition/perform non-attack actions or act as an accuracy buffer in case you miss your attacks. Be careful never to zap an already charmed target though. This heals them and you'll look hella stupid doing it. Always check to make sure the charm has expired before reapplying.

This wand won't charm every enemy. The undead will receive minor damage instead and succubus are completely immune. This is much much less valuable but fortunately only applies to 1 noteworthy ranged enemy: The dwarf warlock.

In addition to the charm/damage this wand will generate a minor shield. If the generated shield is protecting against damage you would've taken anyway, then it's essentially healing you. Which is obviously very good. I've said before that all items translate to HP in some way. This is one of the most direct examples.

This wand can also be used to heal allies. Supposedly that's even intended to be its primary function. Only issue is that it tries to sap your own HP to do it lol. I don't know what Evan was smoking to think that I'd value my ally's health over my own but I do know that he ain't sharing with the rest of us. If you are going to use the wand that way then at least try to zap an enemy first so it takes some shield before it begins to tap into your own health.



Shattered Pixel Dungeon the Complete Newb Adventurer's Guide:

Chapter VI: Fighting Enemies

 v3.0.0

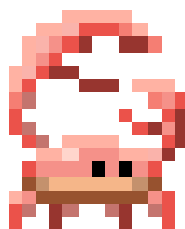


- [Original Reddit Post](#) -

This chapter is going to be dedicated to fighting many of the specific enemies you'll encounter throughout the dungeon. Up until now I've been pretty enemy neutral for the most part. Basically just distinguishing from melee/ranged enemies. The dwarf warlock has probably been my most used example just because they have both a powerful ranged attack and decent enough melee stats. But now it's finally time to get into how to deal with certain enemies such as necromancers, golems, scorpions etc... A lot of enemies have specific stats, properties, abilities or circumstances that may change how you'd want to engage them. Though my intention is not to be a wiki. [u/Zrp200](#) made a [spreadsheet](#) showing enemy info in great detail if that's what you are looking for. It'd be a bit redundant now to make my own. I will however go over how best to engage enemies based on these factors. I probably won't have something to say about every enemy, but I'm sure I will about a lot of them.



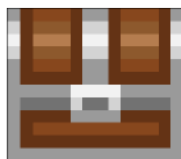
Swarm of Flies: Physical attacks will split them, which I actually find preferable to fighting them without splitting. Divide and conquer. Remember, any attack made against a newly split fly is automatically a sneak attack. Needless to say, AoE is strong against them. A couple other specific weaknesses are fire, as it will spread to each fly as they split. And corruption, as it can corrupt each individually split fly into a full swarm. And this applies for bats too, but try to refrain from killing them over chasms. They drop healing potions which will shatter if they fall!



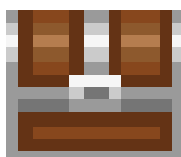
Sewer Crabs: The uncontested kings of the Sewers. They're probably responsible for more deaths than any other enemy. Their speed means that there's not a whole lot you can do about them so early in the game. Apart from just not being underequip. So... don't be underequip. Upgrade a tier-2 if that's what it takes. You can also opt to save any wand/artifact/weapon charge you may have for them. Magic in particular helps as it bypasses both their obnoxious armor and evasion.



Slimes: One of the only defensive enemies in the game. They cannot be 1 shot. They'll greatly reduce the damage received from a single blow if it's too high. This however still leaves them open and quite vulnerable to repeated small amounts of damage. Such as from missile weapons or DOT.



Mimics: These guys aren't technically a Sewers enemy, but they can appear there and beyond so best get used to recognizing them. They are actually quite easy to tell apart from real chests! There are many ways to do so. The best and most immediately noticeable of which is to look at their notch. It's noticeably higher than that of a real chest. A few other methods include:



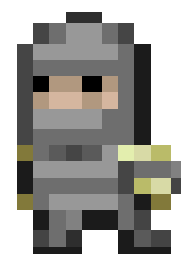
- Their outline is noticeably lighter.
- They will occasionally peek with their eye.
- They won't appear in the fog of war.
- The game will tell you something is off when examining one.

Attempting to open one directly is a bad idea! It will result in you getting whacked. (Ouchy.) Instead, you can use ranged attacks or apply any debuff from afar. Mimics can be quite the brutes so be sure you're prepared in a good position before provoking one.

Skeletons: Only noteworthy thing about them is their bone explosion damage. It's easily negated through armor, but if for any reason you don't have it then avoiding it whenever possible will be necessary. There are only really 2 ways you can. Killing them with ranged attacks or sufficiently weakening them with melee attacks before finishing them with a ranged attack. Their melee attacks are both weaker and tested against your evasion so eating one of them may be preferable at times. Not to mention that your ranged options might be limited so early in the game.



Prison Guards: Every chapter has "that" enemy that just dominates in comparison to the rest. In the Sewers, it's the crabs. Here, it's these fuckers. They have very strong HP and armor relative to their location in the game. Making them absolute brutes. On top of that, they possess chains that can pull you to them and leave you crippled! They have absolutely no qualms pulling you into traps, though they at least won't pull you down chasms. They can also only use their chains once. So after the first use you can treat them like a pure melee enemy. There's not a whole lot special you can do about them. Dodging their chains is akin to avoiding any ranged attack. Don't be underequip, use your items if you have to and treat them with respect.

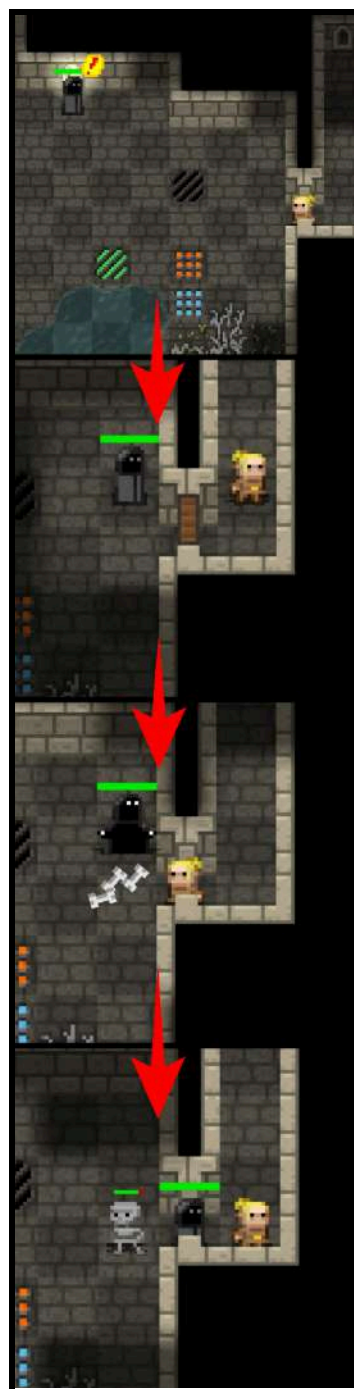




Necromancers: This enemy has some rather unique mechanics. They're completely unable to fight on their own. Instead, they prefer to summon a skeleton to fight for them. Naturally it's best to avoid fighting said skeleton and go straight for the necromancer whenever possible. It can heal its skeleton and give it adrenaline once fully healed.

Making it difficult to flee from. This means DOT is rather effective against them. As it will prevent him from giving his skeleton adrenaline, thus allowing you to kite them as the DOT whittles them both down. Another effective tactic is to afflict the skeleton with something like terror or sleep from a stone. Since they have no means of defense outside of their skeleton, they're completely helpless at that point.

My favorite way to deal with them however is what I call door shuffling. This technique is particularly easy to perform as the Huntress through her Heightened Senses talent. Though all classes are perfectly capable. They just require a little more precision. It's a really fun trick once you get the hang of it. You'll be wanting to do it whenever possible. If you see a necromancer in a room and he hasn't started summoning yet, then wait behind the door until he's right in front of the other side. Next, move into the door, then back out. The necromancer should immediately spot you and begin summoning his skeleton. (This works regardless of whether or not he's already created the skeleton.) After summoning, since the necromancer will know where you are and the skeleton won't, the necromancer will move through first. This will leave the necromancer blocking his own skeleton's path and thus completely helpless! Just remember 2 important things. First, the necromancer must have a tile open to summon beside him. Otherwise he'll attempt to place the skeleton behind you, which is no good. And second, the skeleton must have sight of you after the necromancer walks into the door. If it wanders off out of the necromancer's view then he will re-summon it, ruining the setup. The trickiest part is luring the necromancer in. It's easy if he's asleep or wandering there anyway. Otherwise though the only thing you can do is try and grab their attention from sufficient distance. Unlike most enemies their range is actually shorter than their vision. They're only able to summon from up to 4 tiles away. This restriction does not apply to their healing/teleportation though.





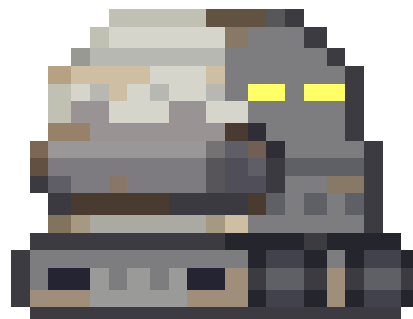
Cave Spinners: Their poison means suffering even a single blow from them can be quite devastating no matter how strong your armor is. So as true for all enemies, best to avoid getting hit. To do that you mainly just have to avoid getting caught in their webs. They root as well as block any ranged attacks!

They can shoot them instantly as they move and will aim in front of whichever direction you're moving towards. Defaulting to in front of/between you. Throwing items (any will do) will destroy them. You can also bait them into webbing the wrong tiles. Take a look at these 2 examples. In the first, you can see that the webs can be sidestepped without losing any space by moving diagonally. In the second one however that's not an option. Instead, here you can opt to spend a turn on a ranged attack. So long as your position remains the same, they'll shoot them between you. Leaving you free to retreat afterwards.



A few items that are particularly effective are the wands of disintegration/fireblast as well as shurikens. These wands can shoot right through webs and will even destroy them in the process! Shurikens just remove them as usual. However, considering that they're thrown instantly, they can therefore negate the webs instantly.

Dm-200s: These are 1 of 2 large enemies you may encounter. They have very strong stats, but are completely confined to the room in which they spawned. To prevent them from being too easily cheesed they'll launch toxic gas if they can see, but not reach you. (Which can actually be beneficial in some cases as it can be used to harm other enemies, as well the spinners' webs for that matter.) Despite this, they're still sitting ducks if you can abuse angles in which you can shoot them from out of sight. Most notably **angles B/C** from chapter II. After luring them to the door you can use B if they're diagonally in front of it, or C if straight.





Elementals: First off, fire and frost elementals are notably weak to their opposing elements. Dying almost instantly to them. Making wands of fireblast/frost a free pass against their opposing element. Next, elementals each have their own unique ranged ability. Most are fairly non-lethal though. Depending on the circumstances you can freely retreat from them and gain space by letting them use their abilities. Blind is pretty non-threatening in general as well as chilled so long as you aren't over water. While fire can be quite harmful, it is however completely negated by water or the glyph of brimstone. Finally, there are chaos elementals which use cursed wand effects. They're unpredictable and thus, you guessed it, chaotic.



Dwarf Monks: They build focus, faster when moving, which allows them to parry any physical attack without fail. Even sneak attacks! They have excellent evasion so sneak attacks are certainly necessary, but best break their focus before executing one. Missiles are a good way to safely do so. Shurikens in particular can easily negate their ability without wasting any turns. Another missile that's quite effective against them are tomahawks! Their armor is almost non-existent so they suffer substantially from the bleed effect. Finally, wands completely bypass their ability. Making them the best option, as usual.

Golems: Instead of toxic gas these large enemies can teleport you behind them. It's only particularly threatening if done in a bad spot so you mainly just have to be mindful of the fact that they can. They're still largely vulnerable to the same cheese as DM-200s. They however may attempt to teleport to another room if they lack sight of you. Always better to finish them while you have a good position. So if you see them readying their teleport, you can actually tag them with a missile weapon to draw their aggro, canceling their ability.



Succubus: They have 2 abilities to watch out for. Their charm and their blink. The charm is easily walked off. So best do so. Even if you have wands to bypass it, they still get healing from attacking a charmed target. Which isn't preferable. So again, walk it off.

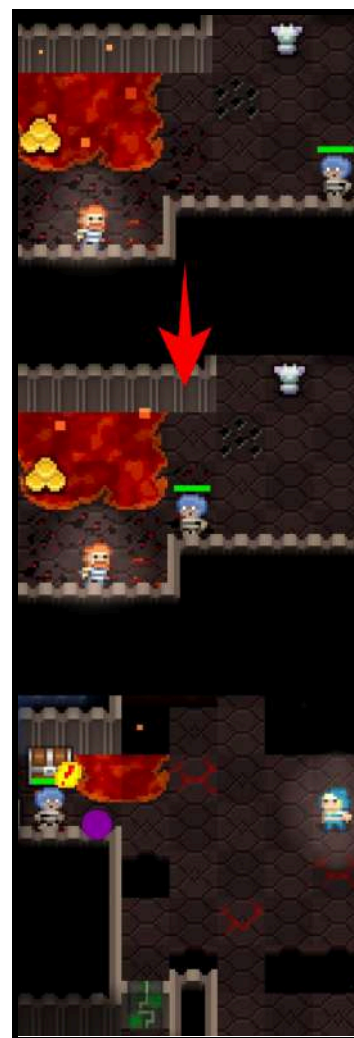
Their blink ability allows them to instantly appear next to you and attack once you've been spotted. Best to avoid damage wherever possible so this can be avoided in a few ways. The most effective of which is to ~~never be spotted~~ to make sure there's never more than 1 tile of space between the both of you. In that case they will instead opt to walk. They are still vulnerable to things such as boosted speed or slow kiting in this case.

The only other option is to waste their teleport as it does have a noticeable cooldown. This can be done by waiting at the end of a corner/holding **angle A/D** from chapter II. This works because they're attempting to teleport directly on top of you. Just like a ranged attack. Since they still need a clear path to you as any ranged enemy would, they can't. Instead they collide with the obstacle and are stopped just as a projectile would be. Thus leaving them back a tile, or in some cases, much more. These angles work because they happen to be the ones where your target can still see you. Statues also work or even a ward placed early in their trajectory. A ward placed on that purple dot for example would negate their teleport completely!

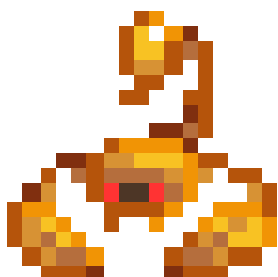


Evil Eyes: Despite being one of the most infamous enemies, they're actually the least threatening of the chapter. And by a lot! That is, once you know how to deal with them. You have to be ready for their deathgaze. Once you see them begin charging you have 2 more turns to reach cover. Walls, statues

and doors are all solid cover and chapter II should have taught you which angles do and don't work. You can also always block vision through grass or sheer distance. Vision is only 6 tiles long in the Demon Halls so if you're fighting them (or any Demon Halls enemy) from a distance it might be easier to break than you realize. Or use items. Wands such as transfusion/blast wave can be of great help. Seeds such as swiftthistle/icecap/fadeleaf or stones of deep sleep/fear for example. Any artifacts, talents or your armor ability. There's a million ways to avoid them. You really shouldn't need a tool to do it the majority of the time, but regardless if you got to the last chapter odds are you've found one by now. My point is that if you're regularly getting hit by them then you really have nobody to blame but yourself.

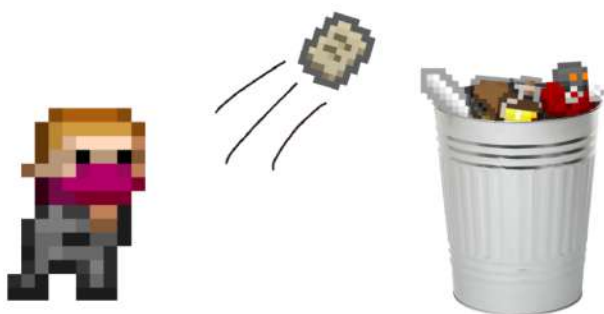


They have a brief cooldown period so once you've evaded one of their deathrays, if necessary, retreat to a position where you know you'll be able to evade it again. That's very important with these enemies. Consider how you'll evade their deathray, **then engage**. Don't attack then consider how you'll evade the beam. Periodically retreating and whittling them down is the best way to handle them. If you do it right then you won't suffer any ranged **or** physical attacks from them. In fact, their deathrays can actually be quite beneficial as they can be used to greatly harm other enemies that you may be kiting. Also worth noting that they are highly resistant to damage while charging ($\frac{3}{4}$ reduction). So that may not be the best time to attack them directly. Though you can still apply debuffs during this time all the same.



Scorpions: These enemies have absolutely no melee capabilities and will instead opt to flee when in melee range. Getting hit by one will leave you crippled and generally miserable. So learning how to outmaneuver them will be important. A couple classic ways to deal with them include waiting in front of a door to smack them or trying to chase them into a dead end room where they will then be trapped helpless. Realistically though you won't be able to corner them everytime.

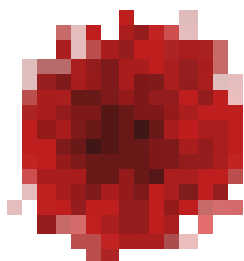
A couple other ~~cheap~~ good strategies include blinding them or outspeeding them. As they have no melee option they're completely unable to fight while blinded. And so long as you're faster than them, be it by slowing them down or speeding yourself up, then you can throw all this strategic bullshit in the garbage! All you have to do is repeatedly whack them at point blank.



As just mentioned with the eyes you should have plenty of tools at this point in the game. If you play well you probably won't need them, but regardless you should have them. So don't be afraid to use them. You absolutely don't want to be caught in a bad position against these guys. All the way back in chapter I I said that you should be using the wait button a lot and that there's really no

reason to be fighting enemies on their own terms. That's especially true here. If you're in no position to fight, then don't. Wait and let them leave. If you can hold a position where they couldn't use a ranged attack no matter how close they got to you, then they will instead prefer to flee rather than approach. Eventually losing sight of you and resuming the wandering state.

Geometry bashing these bitches with all the angles from chapter II is very effective for ranged builds. They're very easy to work in corridors for example. Most notably **angle C** keeps us safely out of sight, allowing their approach. While **angle A** pushes them away. And any attack from more than 6 tiles away will draw them back. Push and pull like the ocean. Be water my friend. It takes practice but once you learn how to dance with them they're not so bad.



Ripper Demons/Spawners: You want to seek out the demon spawner of each depth as quickly as possible to stop the production of rippers. Their locations can be easily revealed through potions of mind vision, scrolls of magic mapping or stones of clairvoyance. Mind vision can even double dip if drunk on the stairs down. Don't try to save any MM at this point. There's decent odds you'll find 1 or 2 of them in this chapter anyway. So if you have any, use them right away on depth 21. If you don't have anything, (or want to save some MV for the boss), then you can always try to follow the rippers directly to the source.

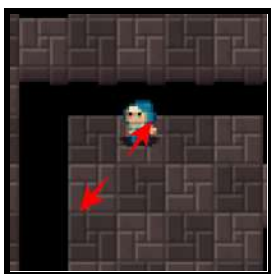
Another little trick is to peek past closed doors. You can often use this to try and gauge what a locked room might contain. Or in this case, recognize the spawner room as it has a different tile design. You may have to zoom in to see it but it's definitely there.



They will produce even more rippers as they take damage. If your armor isn't strong enough to melee them, then you're gonna need a plan. You can always damage the spawner from a distance and retreat to a choke point once you see a ripper appear. By this I mean holding any of the angles from chapter II/any position in which you can reliably handle them. You can also block them from spawning with a stone of flock. Though if you do this be sure to finish the portal off as it will begin spawning rippers retroactively as soon as it's able!

Like slimes, they have damage overload protection. While this means you can't just psionic blast or launch a grim trap at them it also again leaves them quite vulnerable to DOT. A single potion of toxic gas for example is enough to clear one out. A stone of aggression will also destroy them very quickly. Finally, if you have an upgraded wand of disintegration, then once a spawner is located you can easily destroy it from anywhere across the map.

The rippers' leaps are very obnoxious and have almost no cooldown. I have no idea how or why these feral motherfuckers can leap 20 feet across the map on just 2 legs. What I do know however is that they come from the darkest depths of hell. Similar to succubuses, they will try to use their leap to close the gap if it's more than a single tile. And similar to cave spinners, they will aim at wherever you're moving towards. So whatever you do, do **not** stand still when a ripper has a clear path to you. They default to leaping directly on top of you. At which point it is impossible to evade both its leap and regular attacks without the assistance of an item/ability. They'll also try to leap directly on top of you if the tile you moved towards is one that they cannot land on. Such as a wall or statue. The damage from having one land on you is even more punishing than a deathgaze! You absolutely never want to let that happen. If you move in any direction and then the other, then you can at least get them in melee range without suffering any damage. Apart from treating them like any other ranged enemy, another big weakness is their rather low HP and slow wind up on their leap.



My favorite maneuver against them has to be baiting them to jump down chasms. It can be tricky to aggro a ripper at the same time you move toward the edge of chasm, but if you attack them with a shuriken or any other ranged weapon from out of sight, then they'll immediately detect you allowing you to control their leap. You can also look for a spot in which you can move back and forth between 2 chasms. There you can reliably suicide any rippers that may approach.

Shattered Pixel Dungeon the Complete Newb Adventurer's Guide

Chapter VII: Challenges

 v3.0.0



- [Original Reddit Post](#) -

This chapter is going to be dedicated to completing the various challenges built into the game. I've prepared some tips for each individual challenge. Though keep in mind that 99% of my challenge experience has been playing with all of them active at the same time. Remember, being generally good at the game is always going to be most important. The previous chapters will likely help with challenges more than any challenge specific tip ever could. With all the information already given in them there honestly may not be much left to say.

Victory & RNG

Before I go into this chapter there are a few things I want to go over. First of which is flexing my challenge reputation. I've won all-challenges 150+ times! I've also done various self-imposed challenges such as all-challenges no-SoU as Warrior, Mage, Rogue and Huntress (many times), all-challenges no SoU/PoS, all-challenges no torches, (all-challenge) speedruns (both before and after boss reworks), pacifist, perfect score, no damage, pre-rework challenges, etc... In other words I'm well qualified to give challenge advice.

Because it's a very common question I'd like to talk about the luck/RNG aspect of challenges. Particularly when playing with all of them enabled at once. People often wanna know how much luck is necessary to get a win. The answer: Absolutely none. I reach casual win-streaks of 5+ or so all the time. My longest streak being 21! Achieved while playing as the Huntress. Now the losing run was fucking cursed. I mean, I fought like hell but still lost to attrition. It happens. But I'll still admit I made some mistakes and had fault in my death. Hindsight is important. You should always look for things that you could've done better. It's part of how you improve.

Even playing as the Warrior I've still won a few games in a row. You don't really need to find anything special. If you're resourceful enough you can hold out until the Old Wandmaker with just about anything and then you're usually set. And that's with me being far from perfect myself. So is every run winnable? Maybe, maybe not, I don't know. Who gives a fuck? Look there might be a few cases where you're just going to lose. The game can pull some shit sometimes so it's hard to really say "every". But overall it's definitely reasonable to hit a decent win-streak if that's what you're asking. But I also feel it's important to point out, that's almost definitely **not** what you're asking. I'm probably the only guy here stupid enough to try and win-streak this. So does it really even matter? My point is that if I can win 21 games in a row then I don't wanna hear that you got 21 "unwinnable" games in a row. You don't think I've had any uphill games where RNGesus just didn't want me to win? Let me tell you, winning just because of luck feels... well admittedly good because you won. But winning in spite of your luck? That's something else.

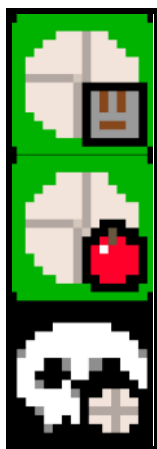
Now how much luck are you realistically going to need to depend on for a win at first? A decent amount. You'll probably need to rely on some good RNG to fill in for the missing experience for a while. But that's really no different than the regular game or any other self-imposed challenge for that matter. Good and bad RNG always have and always will be factors in this game. When I got my first all-challenge win it was with a ring of haste and the lloyd's beacon. At the time I thought that's what it took, I thought you had to get lucky with positioning tools or you just died. But looking back I now see that's simply not true. Now I just play all-challenge runs casually. And I was by no means an inexperienced player when I got that first win. I had already beat the game 250+ times! Really makes me appreciate how high the skill ceiling is in this game without actually seeming so.



Which to leave disabled? If you're going for the 1, 3 or 6 challenge badges then odds are you've had to ask yourself this question. If you're only doing 1 then this probably doesn't matter much. Just don't choose Pharmacophobia. If you're doing 3 I'd probably pick On Diet, Into Darkness and Swarm Intelligence as the easiest. And if you're doing 6 then I'd probably pick Pharmacophobia, Barren Land and Forbidden Runes as the best to leave disabled.

Which class? If you're only doing a few challenges you can do whatever you want. Just don't do something obviously contradictory. Like playing Warrior in Faith is my Armor where he's heavily compromised or Warden in Barren Land. If playing with a lot of chals then it still doesn't really matter. I'm inclined to give it to the Huntress cause, you know, 21 wins. But the Mage, Rogue, Huntress and now Duelist/Cleric (Still haven't played either much yet in all-challenges.) I think are all actually reasonably equal. For your subclass the obvious choices are the Warlock, Freerunner, Sniper and Monk. Though what might surprise you is that I actually prefer Assassin to Freerunner! He already has plenty of positioning through the cloak so IMO he benefits more from the boost in offense. I'll say you're free to choose with Rogue.

On Diet



There's only so much you can do with this challenge. For the most part you'll be rationing your food all the same and just tanking the little bits of extra damage. A few very effective but perhaps lesser known means of satisfying hunger are wells of health, unblessed ankhs and potions of cleansing. All will fully satisfy hunger. You may want to consider pocketing purity potions rather than using them for toxic gas rooms depending on how much you need the gold. A few talents may help a bit as well. Namely Cached Rations, Nature's Bounty and most importantly Soul-Eater. This challenge basically disappears once the Warlock gets that talent.



Apart from that all you can do is try not to waste turns. To do that you have to consider route efficiency. Basically, try to do as little backtracking as possible. Try not to leave branches behind. Wasted time is time for food (and torches if playing Into Darkness as well) to run out while enemies respawn. This is all while putting yourself in a good position against enemies of course. Route efficiency should rarely be your top priority. If you do end up with a room far out of your path you can weigh if between food, (torches) and fighting enemies you think it would cost more than it's worth. Missing the odd room usually isn't that big of a deal, especially if you've already found the SoU. That's one thing that may make backtracking actually worthwhile.



One of my favorite tricks is rushing ahead and doubling back around. Securing the wand from the Old Wandmaker should be your immediate priority as soon as you reach the Prison. So loot what's in your path and hit the stairs down until you reach his depth. After (or sometimes before) securing his wand, for your next target you have to consider if you want to hit your ankh on depth 5 or 10. At some point you have to double back up to finish looting but at the same time you should be aiming your health and hunger to be pretty low when you hit either boss depth. There you can suicide with your ankh where it's safe. Trust me, you'll have hunger/health issues otherwise. Should you fail to trigger your ankh on a safe depth, if you have weak gear it may be wise to prioritize escape tools above all else. Invisibility, Haste, Phase shifts, many artifacts, etc... And remember, on the depth just before the boss, you're free to activate your ankh anytime by chasm dropping! You don't have to take the stairs down.

Another example would be the Caves shop. I do something similar there. You tend to be short on gold as there aren't any gold drops from Prison enemies. You may not immediately be able to buy everything that you want. So loot the next couple depths for gold before making your way back to the shop. The idea behind this tactic is that you leave a path of unexplored territory as you descend so that when you return you're not actually backtracking. Just exploring the depths in a more irregular order. This tactic can really apply to many situations. Shops, unblessed ankhs, wells of health and quests all come to mind. The point is that you don't necessarily have to explore the depths of a chapter linearly. Effective routes save hunger big time.

Faith is my Armor



Needless to say, investing upgrades into armor is no longer going to be worth it. As usual wands will be your best bet. While melee weapons aren't worthless, without armor melee builds aren't that great long-term as you'll be wanting to avoid trading blows wherever possible. If you need to upgrade a weapon short-term then that's fine though. Now I have heard of people upgrading armor anyway just for the sake of surviving the Prison. But I personally don't generally recommend such things.



A classic safety trick in many situations is to throw items/shurikens to open doors. It's a valid way to open them in many cases. Protects against being immediately smacked if there's a wandering enemy on the other side and can make you less likely to immediately wake enemies who were sleeping near the door. Especially useful for enemies such as skeletons or bats that are quite punishing to low-armor builds if you let them get too close.



Once you reach the Prison the lack of armor is going to start seriously hurting. You can bypass it a little bit through a quarterstaff, round shield or even spear if you find one. Those will all make a massive difference. Especially against skeletons. Once past said skeletons it may be worth augmenting your armor in favor of evasion. It will bring more value than a few points of DR. If you really wanna lean into evasion, the Evasive Armor talent grants bonus evasion based on excess strength when freerunning. Which you will have plenty of should you choose to stick with cloth. A couple other good talents are Barkskin and Unencumbered Spirit. The former is the opposite of evasion but can largely reopen melee combat by itself. And the latter is quite literally designed to be used with cloth armor anyway.

A few glyphs that you may want to seek out are swiftness, flow, camouflage, obfuscation or even brimstone. You can almost always get at least one of them. All help in your ability to evade enemies. Glyphs triggered on hit, those aren't as good anymore. And stone? That's just suicide without decent armor to back it up.



In terms of not getting hit all you can really do is try to keep a lid on things. One recipe that will help with that is phase shift. They're an excellent craft that you should basically always make. They're essentially a get out of jail free card that you can play 8 times. Aqua brews are quite versatile as well. Essentially functioning as limited use blast waves. Flock stones are another obvious craft given mirror image scrolls won't be doing much without a melee build.



Darts are incredibly useful. Particularly blinding, paralytic and displacing. You can practically use them as your only positioning tool and still be solid. Between the Durable Projectiles (Only 1 point is needed for a second use on darts.), Point Blank and Durable Tips talents you can lean into them even further as the Huntress. Apart from that, keep your distance from enemies and try not to get yourself cut off. And just about every chapter in this guide can help you there.



Many people may think you absolutely need a consistent positioning tool such as a ring of haste, ethereal chains or hourglass. Which of course isn't true. But, with that said, those are all S-tier items and will make your run go much much smoother. I especially can't knock the ring of haste. A passive speed boost goes beyond just being a consistent spacing/positioning tool. Movement is by far your most common action. A passive boost to movement speed means rations and torches will go further while enemies respawn slower.

Pharmacophobia



Of the 9 challenges in the game Pharmacophobia is by far and away the most difficult. No question about it. Needless to say not being able to easily fully restore your HP 20+ times makes the game significantly harder. However it is sort of an odd challenge in that the only thing it really takes away is your room for error.

Removing health in the form of HP potions is about as direct of a difficulty increase as you can get. It doesn't change the value of anything apart from allowing you to use HP potions in place of others in a few situations. Such as shattering them to extinguish fires, creating free alchemical energy/unstable brews, other potions through the recycle spell or unironically making honeyed healing to throw.

Without potions of healing you'll have to rely on other means of restoring health. There are many obscure/class-specific methods such as vampiric weapons, frozen carpaccio (1/2 chance), Warrior talents, soul-mark, meditate (with the Monastic Vigor talent), etc... But the most reliable are:



- Natural regeneration (Severely limited with On Diet.)
- Dew (Removed with Barren Land.)
- Seeds of sungrass (Removed with Barren Land.)
- Wells of health
- Unblessed ankhs
- Scrolls of lullaby



Notably here lullaby is a full heal so long as you aren't damaged during its use. Be sure that you won't begin to starve during its effect. With the overall lack of healing available unblessed ankhs are much preferable to blessed as you're now far more likely to die by running out of healing rather than from some stupid random mistake. They're safest used on a boss depth, which you will never be more than 2 depths away from. I mentioned them already in On Diet but it's the same idea here too. You want to aim your healing to be on one of the boss depths even if it means exploring the depths non-linearly. Either double back to the start or rush to the end when you start to get low on health. A preserved beacon of returning can also be a safe way to retrieve your inventory if on a non-boss depth.

Get comfortable getting to safety comfortably. You might notice that only one of those healing sources can be quickly activated in a pinch. Which is something I actually really appreciate about this challenge. Other than the waterskin the healing sources you have left can't double as get out of jail free cards like HP potions could. You have to be able to get out of jail first, then you can heal. You can't solve nearly every bad situation by chugging HP potions.

With how scarce healing can be, (especially if you're also playing with Barren Land, which removes mageroyal), distant well rooms usually aren't worth dropping down. Maybe in the first few depths where natural regeneration is still quite potent, but otherwise you have to craft feather fall to prevent the damage. The thing is though, and this goes all the way back to chapter I, I consider this to be true without challenges as well. The secret to being good at pharmacophobia is to manage health well. But is that not just called being good at the game? I've said before that it's hard to call a strategy ineffective if it's saving you far more HP than others. Any habits you pick up to pinch health in here work just as well in the regular game.

If you can learn to comfortably play without potions of healing, then what the hell is really killing you at that point? Now in a regular run I'd of course just jump down, drink an HP potion and be on my way. The question you have to ask yourself is: Is that a better idea when health is more available? Or does health being more available just mean that you're free to play less efficiently?

Barren Land



All plants are removed and seeds will no longer take root. Which kinda sucks but oh well. I'm fine with removing dew and sungrass as like potions of healing, they're just there to give you more health. But I actually would've liked to keep the rest of them! Anyway, they're at least not completely useless. They can still be used for alchemy as well as tipped darts. Try to throw away the less valuable seeds when the type doesn't matter. Save the seeds you like for your darts and potions. You know what to do. Your gameplay overall won't change much. It will no longer be worth trampling every piece of grass, so instead save it for combat instead. (Trampling every tile of grass was kinda tedious anyway.) R.I.P. the Nature's Aid talent and Warden and that's about it.



Swarm Intelligence



Try to be generally aware of swarm intelligence. When an enemy is first alerted to you, they will instantly wake and draw all nearby enemies in an 8 tile radius to your location. **If they've seen it.** So be ready for where more may come from, know where they can't and pay attention to where they don't. It's one of those things it's difficult to give solid advice on. I'm either gonna say something that sounds obvious, vague or abstract. None of which are particularly helpful.

You'll be facing enemies in waves in this challenge and it's something you really just have to adjust yourself to. I could tell you to position yourself in a way that won't result in you getting overwhelmed but that's basically the equivalent of saying "Don't die." at this point. Point is there's no substitute for experience.

A couple solid tips though are playing around that emphasis on "If they've seen it". If you can eliminate an enemy without them ever spotting you, then obviously they won't have a chance to trigger swarm intelligence. Or for a little more obscure trick; If your first attack on an enemy is from out of sight, then they will be alerted to you, but fail to trigger swarm as they won't have eyes on you. Meaning you're free to be spotted and finish them off normally afterwards. They won't attempt to trigger swarm again unless they exit and re-enter the hunting state. Also, if you were planning on taking the Silent Steps talent you may want to reconsider for obvious reasons. (I never liked the talent anyway.)



In the Sewers it's particularly important to learn a little discipline and to stand your ground. It may be difficult to believe but the safest place to be after triggering swarm is usually right where you're currently at. Dispatch your enemies with minimal retreating and stand still a bit afterwards. Make sure there aren't more coming.

Into Darkness



1 torch can be found on each non-boss depth. This is in addition to any other torches that may spawn. Such as from the Demon Halls. Without one your field of view is next to nothing. Only 2 tiles. Halved to 1 on a dark depth! Torches raise that to 6 tiles. Which is still 2 less than the typical 8 but much more manageable.

Remember though, until you reach the Demon Halls, enemies still have the full 8.

One other quick minor warning, be careful when throwing unidentified potions. If they shatter outside of your tiny field of view they'll remain unidentified!

Just like food, you'll have to ration your torches as best you can. With an obvious exception for a dark depth, the first 2 depths should be cleared without the use of any torches. After that you should try to limit it to 1 per depth. So that you never completely run out. The first 3 bosses shouldn't require the use of a torch. You would however be wise to save one for the Dwarf King. Finally, the Demon Halls are dark anyway. Meaning this challenge is effectively over upon reaching there. But despite that the game still spawns the additional torch! As far as I'm aware this is the only time a challenge is just plain beneficial.

When in the Sewers without a torch, (and sometimes even with, especially with Swarm Intelligence active,) it's often a good idea to wait at the start of a room for a few turns to see if there's any enemies already approaching from the dark. That way the door is right there in case there's an entire armada lurking in the shadows.



Torches only last 250 turns each. Even if you manage them pretty well you're still going to inevitably be doing some fighting in the dark. So best get comfortable with it. Vision boosting talents can largely alleviate this challenge. Namely Heightened Senses, Arcane Vision, Seer Shot, Farsight and Divine Sense. As the Huntress you can also just blindfire to check if you hit anything from time to time.

Forbidden Runes



7 of your SoU are removed. Leaving 8 of them split between chapters in a 2, 1, 2, 1, 2 pattern. Despite this upgrade reduction I'd still however recommend you spend them in more or less the same way. I still make short-term investments, upgrade +0s, it's all the same to me.

This challenge can be similar to Pharmacophobia in that it's one of the more difficult challenges in the game, but the game itself won't change much other than you being significantly weaker. Though the Huntress isn't hit quite as hard as the other classes. Having a consistent source of ranged damage independent of upgrades is a very big deal. She wrecks shop with minimal upgrades even in the Demon Halls! Making her the go-to class for no, or in this case, low-SoU runs.

Hostile Champions

You sense a deadly presence.

There are 6 different types of champions you may encounter. 2 offensive oriented, 2 defensive and 2 that are mixed. All of which spawn awake, which is kind of annoying. Mainly you just have to acknowledge and play around their new strengths and be a little more willing to use your consumables against them. But as per usual I'll cover each one:



Growing: They become infinitely stronger as time passes, but otherwise possess no special abilities. They can be examined to gauge their current lethality and if it's still realistic to challenge them. If you let them wander too long you may as well forget about killing them.

Blessed: They have insanely high accuracy/evasion. Ultimately they're weak to the same things all evasive enemies are. Sneak attacks and wands. Not much else to do here.

Projecting: They can attack from up to 4 tiles away and much more freely than a standard ranged enemy could. Their attacks can bend around terrain just like a whip or spear. Eliminating them from either out of reach or out of sight is a must.

Blazing: They apply burning on hit and erupt into flames upon death. They however have no ranged or defensive capabilities so just keep your distance and don't get hit. If that's not an option then all you can do is find water.

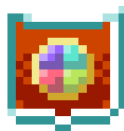
Giant: They cannot fit through corridors, but they have a huge amount of HP to compensate. Effective x5! (As well as +1 reach.) This leaves them vulnerable to the typical techniques for dealing with large enemies. Though due to their extreme resilience, outside of the spirit bow you may not always have the needed damage available to kill them. The only alternative is trying to avoid them entirely. Which is quite possible considering they're confined to their spawned room. And, as with all champions, (except anti-magic), you can always just put them to sleep with a stone.

Anti-Magic: They are immune to most magical effects and on top of that have effective x2 HP! This means, for the first time ever, wands might actually not be the best thing in the game. They're still vulnerable to the effects of wands though. Just not the direct damage. Fireblast and corrosion's DOT still work and corruption is actually even stronger! These champions have immunity to a few debuffs such as weakened, vulnerable, hex, charm and deep sleep. The first 3 of which are applicable with corruption and conveniently also the least useful. Meaning it will instead prefer to apply a different, more useful debuff.



The Assassin is my favorite class to counter champions. With maxed Enhanced Lethality he can freely delete any that are problematic! Even a giant champion can be instantly killed with a dart. Abilities like that are what makes him a legitimate choice in all-challenges.

Badder Bosses



The **Goo** can now pump up in just 2 turns instead of 3! It can no longer be avoided by simply backing away. You will instead be forced to rely upon doors, grass, corners or the Rogue's cloak. Its pump is a bit of an oddity in that for it to succeed it needs to have a clear path to you **and back**. This makes it a bit easier to evade with corners.



For example, both sides of **angle A** from chapter II would work where normally only 1 would. It will now heal exponentially in water so preventing it from having too much time in there is important. The quickest, easiest and most consistently available way of making space is actually around the gate to the Prison. Circling it while repeatedly using **angle C**.

The **Tengu** is notably stronger, mainly during his second phase. Previously, if you paralyzed him at the start you likely wouldn't suffer a single shuriken. But now, he throws his shurikens in addition to his abilities! This makes taking some damage pretty much inevitable in this phase. Clearing the Prison just to die to this punk is quite depressing so I will add a little bit more on him.

The first phase is basically the same. Potion of shrouding fog or alternatively stones of flock thrown around oneself (only with fireblast, disintegration, corrosion or warding) can work as cover. After that, even in the second phase it's still pretty much the same idea. Paralyze him then load up as much damage and DOT as you can. Always attack for the first turn spent in a shadow bomb. You want to try and dodge his bombs and shockers at the same if possible. Stones of blink/potions of haste can free up some turns that would otherwise be spent dodging his abilities and can save you if he's beginning to build you into a corner. Honeypots can distract him for a little bit. The elixir of dragon's blood can give you fire damage while also protecting you from his combustion. Flock/shroud are still good for additional cover. Blast stones are great for fast and cheap damage. Tele-grab if you're short on ranged damage.

Throw everything you got at him! Like I said, dying to this guy sucks. Don't worry too much about wasting your resources. Worry about making him dead. He's the last big hurdle before you get a substantial power boost in the form of your subclass. Nearly every all-challenge run that gets past him results in a victory.

The **DM-300** now activates 3 pylons instead of 2 and has an obnoxious amount of traps to draw shields from. Regardless, it's the same plan. One neat thing about it triggering 3 pylons is that the final one will at least be predictable. It will never activate the pylon closest to you.



If you're playing with many challenges there's a fair chance you don't have a lot in terms of damage available to you. So try not to waste too much ammo on its shields. Sleep in the corners to wait them out if possible. Cleansing darts are also an option for removing them.

One particularly cheesy strat is to place a single ward inside the center of the arena. If you place it at reverse **angle A** from chapter II, it will hold the DM-300's attention indefinitely. Leaving you free to attack so long as you remain out of sight. It will switch targets if it spots you.

The pylons are a little more durable this time around and with a little more electricity. So safest to just damage them from a tile back. Still watch the electricity though. You may have to cut across to switch sides at some point if the DM-300 is right on you.

When facing the **Dwarf King** you want to match the terrain to your glyph. Water to take advantage of a glyph of flow, regrowth bombs (only with Pharmacophobia) for camouflage or infernal brews for brimstone. He gets a big power boost but he's really the same boss. The items you'd want to use against him might be more necessary now, but they're still the same items. One thing I will mention that I didn't in chapter I is the blizzard brew. When combined with water it can effectively perma-stun. Makes for a very short first phase if you have sufficient DPS.

Same with **Yog-Dweza**. I don't have a lot to say. Just spam alchemy lol. I will say though that psionic blast may be more worthwhile than it was before. He now summons 2 fists instead of just 1. So the damage dealt by it is effectively doubled. And taking out rippers at the same time is more valuable than just larva.

The recoil on psionic blast can be quite severe if used on only a couple targets though! You can counteract it by throwing a stone of flock down beforehand to boost the target count. Another sweet flock stone synergy is with stones of shock. They also benefit from a high target count and will instantly recharge all of your wands if it collects enough targets.

The End

Many people say that challenges just remove things from the game. But with all the improvements Evan has made to them over time I actually think they're in an alright spot right now. Pharmacophobia and Forbidden Runes, while they technically do remove items, the result is a very direct difficulty increase with little gameplay difference. On Diet and Into Darkness I wouldn't say remove food/vision but rather give you a resource that you need to seriously manage. Faith is my Armor does largely remove armor, however that also changes gameplay in a very meaningful way. It forces you to adopt a more offensive play style and rely on avoiding attacks entirely. Swarm Intelligence, Hostile Champions and Badder Bosses all directly make enemies stronger rather than yourself weaker. (Ironically enough, Hostile Champions is probably the least fair challenge.) The one thing I will concede though is that Barren Land does indeed remove plants. While seeds do have other uses, it is true that one of them, the primary one in fact, is just straight removed. What I suspect people actually dislike from challenges is the difficulty. Which I mean, is perfectly reasonable. This is a difficult game as is! Stacking challenges on top of that is going to prove too much for most players. Especially considering they get exponentially more difficult the more you stack. Regardless, if it weren't for challenges I probably would've stopped playing the game by now. And with this I'd say this guide is complete! (For now anyway.) Happy dungeoneering guys. Good luck and mad respect to anyone who actually read the whole guide!

